

SIX
METAPHYSICAL
MEDITATIONS;

Wherein it is Proved
That there is a

G O D.

And that Mans MIND is
really distinct from his BODY.

Written Originally in Latin
By *RENATUS DES-CARTES*.

Hereunto are added the OBJECTI-
ONS made against these Meditations.

By *THOMAS HOBBS*
Of *Malmesbury*.

With the *AUTHORS* Answers.

All Faithfully Translated into *ENG-
LISH*, with a short Account of
Des-Cartes's Life.

By *WILLIAM MOLYNEUX*.

London, Printed by *B.G.* for *Benj. Tooke* at
the *Ship* in *St. Pauls Church-yard*, 1680.

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Title: Six metaphysical meditations

Wherein it is proved that there is a God and that mans mind is really distinct from his body

Author: René Descartes

Contributor: Thomas Hobbes

Translator: William Molyneux

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK SIX
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Some Books sold by *John Lawrence*, at the *Angel* in *Cornhill*, near the *Royal Exchange*.

A Collection of Letters for the improvement of Husbandry and Trade, intended to be continued Monthly, by *John Houghton*, fellow of the *Royal Society*, 'tis designed that every Letter shall be usefull to Mankind, and by degrees for most persons of both Sexes.

The *Merchant Royal*, (a very pleasant Sermon) Preached before the King at *White-Hall*, upon the Nuptials of an Honourable Lord and his Lady, in Quarto, price 6*d*.

Humane Prudence, or the Art by which a man may raise himself and Fortune to Granduer, by *A. B.*, the second Edition, with the Addition of a Table; in Twelves, price Bound, 1*s*.

THE TRANSLATORS PREFACE. TO THE READERS.

Had honor or applause and not the publick advantage of English Readers been the design of this Undertaking, the consideration of the common Fate of Translations had discouraged Me from permitting this even to have seen the light; for meer Versions do alwayes carry with them this Property, that if not well done they may much disgrace, but if well, not much commend the doers.

And certainly I might well have expected the same chance, had this been the Translation of an History, Play or Romance; wherein there is requisite not onely a bare version but a conformation of Idiom and language, manner and customary expression; But the nature of this present Work will not admit of the like liberty, and therefore, I hope, amongst Judicious Readers it may be exempt from the common Fate of Translations; for if we look upon it as a Philosophical or Metaphysical Tract, or rather as (really it is) a Physico-Mathematical Argumentation, we shall find that a great strictness of Expression is requisite to be observed therein. So that had a Translator taken upon him to use his own liberty of Phrase, he would thereby have endanger'd the sense and force of the Arguments; for Politeness of language might as well be expected in a Translation of Euclide as in this. And all that are acquainted with this famous Authors design, do very well know, that it was his intention in these Meditations Mathematically to demonstrate, that there is a God, and that mans mind is incorporeal. And it was his opinion, that metaphysicks may as clearly be demonstrated as mathematicks, as witness his expression in the Dedicatory Epistle of this Work to the Sorbone Doctors, Eas (Rationes scilicet) quibus hic utor certitudine & evidentiâ Geometricas æquare, vel etiam superare existimem;

That he reputed his Arguments used in these Meditations, to equal if not excell Geometrical certainty.

And this, I suppose, is sufficient to make the Reader, not expect herein any smoothness of phrase or quaintness of Expression; what is here delivered in English is immediately taken, as it is naturally in the Original. The words, we hope, may be apposite enough, and fit to express what is here designed, and I think it a derogation from the Authors skill to draw the Picture of his mind in any other Colours, than what his own Copy expresses.

Thus far in vindication of the Philosophical plain stile and rough Language of the following Translation. I shall add a line or two, first relating to the Readers, secondly of the Author, and lastly of the Meditations themselves, together with the Motives which excited me to this Work.

As to the Readers, 'tis, I suppose, so evident that candour of mind, and freedome from prejudice is requisite to all that desire to advantage themselves by reading other mens notions, that it need not be here insisted on with much earnestness; yet considering the Antiquity of this subject, and the novelty of the Arguments here produced, it seems to be more than ordinarily requisite for an impartial perusal of the ensuing Tract. Neither are the following Meditations to be slightly passed over, but with diligence and attention to be read; for as in mathematical demonstration, the careless missing of any one single Position may render the Conclusion obscure and sometimes inconsequent, so in these metaphysical Demonstrations, which (as, before has been noted from the illustrious Author thereof) for certainty do equal, if not excel Geometrical Propositions, the slight attention to any one particular Argument may frustrate the design of the whole discourse.

The Reasoning therefore here being close and solid, and (as in Mathematicks) the knowledge of the latter depending on the knowledge of what went before, 'tis the duty of every Reader seriously to attend the Particulars, as also the connexion of the whole. Let him weigh the Arguments and perpend the Conclusions, and after a clear and distinct Knowledge, lett him pass his judgement.

And to this end I shall make it my request to every Reader, that he would not be content with a single perusal of the following Discourses, but that he would often repeat his reading them over; for by this means the force of

those Arguments, which at first may by chance escape the most diligent and attentive Peruser, by a second or third Essay may offer themselves more fully to his Consideration. This was the desire of our Author in an other of his pieces, I mean his Principles of Philosophy, which I am sure do not require so strict an attention of mind, as these abstracted speculations; and therefore if it were his Request in that case, we may Reasonably think that 'twas no less his desire in this.

When we come to speak of the Incomparable Author of these Meditations, we have reason to lament our own Ignorance, and to blame the Ingratitude of the Age wherein he lived, for not transmitting to Posterity more certain and ample Records of the Life and Conversation of this Excellent Philosopher, all that has been Written in this kind gives us only so much light into the Life of this Prodigious Man, as may make us wish for more; imparting which, I shall recommend the Readers to a further enquiry into the inward Thoughts, (largly discover'd in the Writings) of our Famous Author, of whose outward actions and condition we have so small knowledge.

Renatus Des-Cartes was born on the last day of March in the year 1596. at Tours, or at Castrum Eraldum a Town near Tours in France; He came of an Antient and Noble Family, being by Descent Lord of Perron, His Father was a Senator of his Country, and a Man of no mean estate, leaving to this his only Son by a second Wife between six and seven thousand pounds a year.

He was Educated in his younger years according to the manner of his Country (and as he himself recommends in one of his Epistles, viz. Epist. 90. partis secundæ to One for the Instruction of his Son) in the Aristotelian principles of Philosophy, a whole course whereof he had run through at the Age of seventeen in the Schools of Flexia, or La Flesche a Town in the Province of Anjou, famous for the Colledge of Jesuites there establish'd by Henry the 4th.

But to this he did not Continue long devoted, giving early testimonies of his dislike to the unsatisfactory Notions, and verbose emptiness of the Peripatetick Philosophy; He used therefore his utmost endeavours (as he himself testifies in his Dissertatio de Methodo) to get loose from those

Chains and Fetters of Mind to which the weakness of his tender years had subjected him.

To this end he betook himself to a long course of Travel, that by the variety of Objects, which he was likely to meet with in his journeys, the memory of his past Notions might be blotted out; In his travel he applied himself much to the study of the Art Military, and Mathematicks; In the latter he has left the World large testimonies of his Excellence in his Book of Geometry; and in the former we have reason to believe him most expert, for He was personally present at some Sieges and Battles both in France and Germany, as particularly at the Siege of Rochel, of Gava near Genoa, of Breda, at the Battle of Prague, &c. so that we may conclude that he had a Genius fitted (according to the Motto of the noble Sir W. Raliegh) Tam Marti, quam Mercurio, For the Pike as well as Pen. And as the Glorious Roman Emperour became a Cæsar by his Book as well as Sword, by the Conquests of his mind as well as those of his arm; so our Famous Author was Ex Utroque Clarus.

In his Travels he spent many years, in all which time he was not Idle, but highly improved himself by his converse with the Beaux Esprits, which he met with in several Regions he visited; The first Place he betook himself to, was Italy, then he went into Denmark, Germany, Hungary, &c. And after a Long but advantagious Peregrination he return'd to Amsterdam, where he intended to take up his Rest, had he not been called by the French King upon very Honourable terms to Paris; During his Continuance there he so order'd his annual Revenue, that he might be supplied by the hands of a Friend wherever he was. He staid at Paris three years, and then retired Himself to a solitary village in Holland called Egmond, where he lived twenty five years, during which time he apply'd himself wholly to the Restauration of true Philosophy, wherein he gave the World such mighty testimonies of his Excellence, that in a short time he became celebrated in the mouths of all Learned Men. Neither were the Courts of Princes silent in his deserved Praises; for after a Retirement of twenty five years he was Invited by Christina Queen of Sweedland to her Court; Thither upon the intreaty of this brave and Learned Princess he betook himself, where he had not continued Long before he was struck with a Peripneumonia or Inflammation of the Lungs (contracted, as it is thought by the long Discourses which he used to hold bare headed with the Queen, continuing

them sometimes till far in the Night,) of which unhappy distemper he Died the seventh Day after he sicken'd.

Thus Expired this Wonder of his Own and succeeding Ages, desired and lamented by all men, Æqual'd by none. He was buried in a costly Monument consisting of four sides, upon which were inscribed Epitaphs; bestow'd upon him by many Renown'd Persons.

What shall we now say sufficient to express our Grief for the untimely Decease of this Worthy Philosopher? But Especially what shall we now do to recover our Loss? Let us endeavour to Redeem what we have lost by well Husbanding and careful improvement of what is left; which may be done in Part by a Diligent Perusal of the Works written by this Excellent Author; This, This only is the way of Reviving him again, and of giving him Immortality in spite of his untimely Fate. And so let him for ever live celebrated by the Deserved Praises of all ingenious Enquirers after truth, and Learning.

Let us therefore cast our eye upon the Present Work of this extraordinary Philosopher, and therein let us admire his profound Judgment and vigorous Fancy, for if we seriously consider it, we shall hardly find a more solid close piece of Reasoning either in this or Foregoing ages; Here, what was commonly asserted without proof, is not only proved but Mathematically Demonstrated, viz. That God is the Fountain and Original of Truth; His sharp Wit, like Hannibals Vinegar, hath eaten thro the Mazing and overtowering hills of Errors, a Plain and Pleasant Way to the Divine seat of Knowledge.

In fine, such is the Excellence of these six Meditations, that I cannot resemble his Performance herein better than to the Six Days Work of the Supream Architect; and certainly next to the Creation of All things out of Nothing, the Restauration of Truth out of Errors is the most Divine Work; so that (with Reverence be it spoken) the Incomparable Des-Cartes does hereby deserve as it were the name of a Creatour. In the first Meditation we are Presented with a Rude and Indigested Chaos of Errours and Doubts, till the Divine spirit of the Noble Des-Cartes (pardon the Boldness of the Expression) moves upon the confused face of these Waters, and thereout produces some clear and distinct Light; by which Sun-shine he proceeds to bring forth and cherish other Branches of Truth; Till at last by a six Days

Labour he Establishes this Fair Fabrick (as I may call it) of the Intellectual World on foundations that shall never be shaken. Then sitting down with rest and satisfaction he looks upon this his Off-spring and Pronounces it Good.

These Things Consider'd, I need not make any long Apologies for my undertaking a translation thereof; The excellency of the Original is sufficient to vindicate my endeavours to present the English World with a Copy, and he that shall blame my Intentions of Communicating the Methods of Truth to those that have only the English Tongue, may as well find fault with those English that propagate the Christian Religion among savage Indians, and translate the Scriptures into their Language, because they have not the English Tongue. To understand Latin is no (or at most a very small) part of Learning, and that which certainly every Cobler in Rome was once endow'd with; and therefore must there then be no translations out of Greek into Latin? I doubt not, but there are many Persons in our Nations, who tho wanting Latin, are notwithstanding very capable of the most abstracted speculations; the late disturbances of our Kingdomes occasion'd many Youths, who were then in a fair way of Instruction, to forsake their learning, and divert their intentions from Literature to Arms, and yet many of these have afterwards become Men of extraordinary nary abilities and qualifications for learning notwithstanding their deficiency in the Roman Tongue. And I see no Reason why it should not be the desire, and consequently the endeavour of every true English man, to make his language as universal as is now the French, into which the best Books in all sorts of Learning, both Poetry and Prose, are daily translated out of all languages, but especially out of Greek and Latine. Among which these Meditations are to be found, entituled, Les Meditations Metaphysiques De Rene Des Cartes touchant la Premiere Philosophie. This was translated out of the Authors Latine into French by Monsieur le D. D. L. N. S. The several Objections also, which were made by divers learned Persons against these Meditations, with the Authors Answers, were translated into French by M. B. L. R. And, I hope, no one will assert, that the French are more fit to receive those metaphysical Notions delivered herein than the English Nation.

But 'twas none of the smallest motives I had to this undertaking, that tho some famous English Authours have taken notice of the Arguments here

produced (for the proof of a Deity drawn from the Idea we have of God in our Mind, &c.) Particularly the most excellent and learned Dr. Stillingfleet in the first Chapter of the third Book in his Origines Sacræ, who refers his Readers to a further search into these Meditations in the 400 page of that Discourse; as also the Reverend Dr. Henry More in his Antidote against Atheism, and more fully in his Appendix annex'd thereto, hath treated of our Authors demonstration; and yet nothing of the genuine original from whence they have borrowed all their Copies (tho some of them drawn in a larger size, yet I question whether so expressive) nothing of our Authors proper management hath ever appear'd in English. Those that assert these Arguments to have been long before thought upon by some of the Fathers, I shall refer to our Authors just vindication of himself in his several Answers to Objections made against these Discourses.

And here I shall dismiss the Reader detaining him no longer from that satisfaction which he may reasonably expect from the perusal of the following Meditations; this Translation is dedicated to no one in particular, but is humbly submitted to the moderate censure of all candid Readers, by

*Their humble servant
Will. Molyneux.*

Dublin Feb. 19. 1679/80.

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ERRATA.

Pag. 1. line 8. dele *off*. p. 3. l. 21. *there wants the sign of Interrogation*. p. 8. l. 10. r. *Premeditated*. ib. l. 14. r. *falshoods*. p. 18. l. 15. r. *that it may*. p. 20. l. 11. r. *suffers*. *In the two or three first chapters there are Astericks wanting*. p. 33. l. 10. dele I. p. 39. l. 25. r. *formally*. p. 49. l. 14 r. *Duration and Continuance*. p. 54. l. 2 *for the Point put a Comma*. p. 61. l. ult. r. *I enquire*. p. 91. r. *in the margin doubted*. p. 124. l. 6. r. *have no affinity*.

Transcriber's Note: These errata have been corrected, along with some obvious typos. The spelling in this book is not only of its time, but also wildly variable, and has been left well alone.

THE
Metaphysical Meditations
OF
Renatus Des-Cartes, &c.

MEDITAT. I.

Of Things Doubtful.

Some years past I perceived how many *Falsities* I admitted as *Truths* in my Younger years, and how *Dubious* those things were which I raised from thence; and therefore I thought it requisite (if I had a designe to establish any thing that should prove *firme* and *permanent* in sciences) that once in my life I should clearly cast aside all my former opinions, and begin a new from some *First principles*. But this seemed a great Task, and I still expected that maturity of years, then which none could be more apt to receive Learning; upon which Account I waited so long, that at last I should deservedly be blamed had I spent that time in *Deliberation* which remain'd only for *Action*.

This day therefore I conveniently released my mind from all cares, I procured to my self a Time Quiet, and free from all Business, I retired my self Alone; and now at length will I freely and seriously apply my self to the General overthrow of all my former Opinions.

To the Accomplishment of Which, it will not be necessary for me to prove them all *false* (for that perhaps I shall never atcheive) But because my reason perswades me, that I must withdraw my assent no less from those opinions which seem *not so very certain* and *undoubted*, then I should from those that are *Apparently false*, it will be sufficient if I reject all those wherein I find any *Occasion* of doubt.

Neither to effect this is it necessary, that they all should be run over particularly (which would be an endles trouble) but because the *Foundation* being once undermin'd, whatever is built thereon will of its own accord come to the ground, I shall therefore immediately assault the very *principle*, on which whatever I have believed was *grounded*. Viz.

Whatever I have hitherto admitted as most true, that I received either from, or by my Senses; but these I have often found to deceive me, and 'tis prudence never certainly to trust those that I have (tho but once) deceived us.

1 *Doubt.* But tho sometimes the *senses* deceive us being exercised about *remote* or *small* objects, yet there are many other things of which we cannot doubt tho we know them only by the senses? as that at present I am in this place, that I am sitting by a fire, that I have a Winter gown on me, that I feel this Paper with my hands; But how can it be denied that these hands or this body is mine? Unless I should compare my self to those mad men, whose brains are disturbed by such a disorderly melancholick vapour, that makes them continually profess themselves to be Kings, tho they are very poor, or fancy themselves cloathed in Purple Robes, tho they are naked, or that their heads are made of Clay as a bottle, or of glass, &c. But these are mad men, and I should be as mad as they in following their example by fancying these things as they do.

1 *Solution.* This truly would seem very clear to those that never *sleep*, and suffer the same things (and sometimes more unlikely) in their repose, then these mad men do whilst they are awake; for how often am I perswaded in a Dream of these usual occurrences, that I am in this place, that I have a Gown on me, that I am sitting by a fire, &c. Tho all the while I am lying naked between the Sheets.

But now I am certain that I am awake and look upon this Paper, neither is this head which I shake asleep, I knowingly and willingly stretch out this hand, and am sensible that things so distinct could not happen to one that sleeps. As if I could not remember my self to have been deceived formerly in my sleep by the like thoughts; which while I consider more attentively I am so far convinced of the difficulty of distinguishing sleep from waking that I am amazed, and this very amazement almost perswades me that I am asleep.

2 *Doubt.* Wherefore let us suppose our selves *asleep*, and that these things are not *true*, viz. that we open our eyes, move our heads, stretch our hands, and perhaps that we have no such things as hands or a body. Yet we must confess, that what we see in a Dream is (as it were) *a painted Picture*, which cannot be devised but after the *likeness* of some *real* thing; and that therefore these Generals at least, viz. eyes, head, hands, and the whole body are things *really existent* and not *imaginary*; For Painters themselves, (even then when they design Mermaids and Satyrs in the most unusual shapes) do not give them natures altogether new, but only add the divers Parts of different Animals together; And if by chance they invent any thing so new

that nothing was ever seen like it, for that 'tis wholly fictitious and false, yet the colours at least of which, they make it must be *true Colours*; so upon the same account, tho these General things as eyes, head, hands, &c. may be imaginary; yet nevertheless we must of necessity confess the more *simple* and *universal* things to be *True*, of which (as of true Colours) these *Images* of things (whether *true* or *false*) which are in our minds are made; such as are the nature of a body in General, and its Extension, also the shape of things extended, with the quantity or bigness of them; their number also, and place wherein they are, the time in which they continue, and the like, and therefore from hence we make no bad conclusion, that *Physick*, both *Natural*, and *Medicinal*, *Astronomy*, and all other *sciences*, which depend on the consideration of *compound things*, are *Doubtful*. But that *Arithmetick*, *Geometry*, and the like (which treat only of the most *simple*, and *General* things not regarding whether they really are or not) have in them something *certain* and *undoubted*; for whether I sleep or wake, *two* and *three* added make five; a *square* has no more sides than *four* &c. neither seems it possible what such *plain truths* can be *doubted* off.

2 *Solution*. But all this While there is rooted in my mind a certain old opinion of the *being* of an *Omnipotent God*, by whom I am *created* in the state I am in; and how know I but he caused that there should be no Earth, no Heaven, no Body, no Figure, no Magnitude, no Place, and yet that all these things should seem to me to be as now they are? And as I very often judge others to *erre* about those things which they think they *Thoroughly understand*, so why may not I be *deceived*, whenever I add *two* and *three*, or count the sides of a Square, or whatever other easy Matter can be thought of?

3. *Doubt*. But perhaps *God* wills not that I should be *deceived*, for he is said to be *Infinitely Good*.

3. *Solution*. Yet if it were *Repugnant* to his *Goodness* to create me so that I should be *always deceived*, it seems also *unagreeable* to his *Goodness* to permit me to be deceived *at any time*; Which last no one will affirme: Some there are truly who had rather deny *Gods Omnipotence*, then beleive all things *uncertain*; but there at present we may not contradict. And we will suppose all this of *God* to be *false*; yet whether they will suppose me to become what *I* am by Fate, by *Chance*, by a *continued chain* of causes, or any other way, because to *erre* is an *Imperfection*, by how much the less

power they will Assigne to the *Author* of my *Being*, so much the more Probable it will be, that I am so *Imperfect* as to be *always deceived*.

To which Arguments I know not what to answer but am forced to confess, that there is nothing of all those things which I formerly received as *Truths*, whereof at present I may not *doubt*; and this doubt shall not be grounded on inadvertency or Levity, but upon strong and Premeditated reasons; and therefore I must hereafter (if I designe to discover any truths) withdraw my assent from them no less then from *apparent falshoods*.

But 'tis not sufficient to think only *Transiently* on these things, but I must take care to *remember* them; for daily my old opinions returne upon me, and much against my Will almost possesse my Beleife tyed to them, as it were by a continued *use* and *Right of Familiarity*; neither shall I ever cease to *assent* and *trust* in them, whilst I suppose them as in themselves they really are, that is to say, *something doubtful* (as now I have proved) yet notwithstanding *highly Probable*, which it is much more Reasonable to beleive then disbeleive.

Wherefore I conceive I should not do amiss, if (with my mind bent clearly to the contrary side) I should deceive my self, and suppose them for a While altogether *false* and *Imaginary*; till at length the Weights of prejudice being equal in each scale, no ill custome may any more Draw my Judgement from the *true Conception* of things, for I know from hence will follow no dangerous Error, and I can't too immoderately pamper my own Incredulity, seeing What I am about, concernes not *Practice* but *Speculation*.

To Which end I will suppose, not an *Infinitely perfect God*, the *Fountain* of *truth*, but that some *Evil Spirit* which is very *Powerful* and *crafty* has used all his endeavours to *deceive* me; I will conceive, the Heavens, Air, Earth, Colours, Figures, Sounds, and all outward things are nothing else but the delusions of Dreams, by which he has laid snares to catch my easy beleif; I will consider my self as not having hands, Eyes, Flesh, Blood, or Sences, but that *I* falsely think that *I* have all these; *I* will continue firmly in this Meditation; and tho it lyes not in my power to *discover any truth*, yet this is in my power, not to *assent to Falsities*, and with a strong resolution take care that the *Mighty deceiver* (tho never so *powerful* or *cunning*) impose not any thing on my beleife.

But this is a laborious intention, and a certain sloth reduces me to the usual course of life, and like a Prisoner who in his sleep perhaps enjoy'd an imaginary liberty, and when he begins to suppose that he is asleep is afraid to waken, but is willing to be deceived by the *Pleasant delusion*; so I willingly fall into my opinions, and am afraid to be Roused, least a toilsome waking succeeding a pleasant rest I may hereafter live not in the *light*, but in the confused *darkness* of the *doubts* now raised.

MEDITAT. II.
Of the nature of Mans mind, and that 'tis easier
proved to be then our body.

By yesterdays Meditation I am cast into so great *Doubts*, that I shall never forget them, and yet I know not how to answer them, but being plunged on a suddain into a deep Gulf, I am so amazed that I can neither touch the bottome, nor swim at the top.

Nevertheless, I will endeavour once more, and try the way I set on yesterday, by removing from me whatever is in the *least doubtful*, as if I had certainly discover'd it to be *altogether false*, and will proceed till I find out some *certainty*, or if nothing else, yet at least this *certainty*, *That there is nothing sure.*

Archimedes required but a *point* which was *firm*, and *immoveable* that he might move the *whole Earth*, so in the perfect undertaking Great things may be expected, if I can discover but the *least thing* that is *true* and *indisputable*.

Wherefore I suppose all things I see are *false*, and believe that nothing of those things are really existent, which my deceitful memory represents to me; 'tis evident I have no senses, that a Body, Figure, Extension, Motion, Place, &c. are meer Fictions; what thing therefore is there that is *true*? perhaps only *this*, *That there is nothing certain.*

But how know I that there is nothing *distinct* from all these things (which I have now reckon'd) of which I have no reason to *doubt*? Is there no *God* (or whatever other name I may call him) who has put these thoughts into me? Yet why should I think this? When I my self perhaps am the *Author* of them. Upon which Account, therefore must not I be something? 'tis but just now that I denied that I had any *senses*, or any *Body*. Hold a while—Am I so tied to a *Body* and *senses* that I cannot *exist* without them? But I have perswaded my self that there is nothing in the World, no Heaven, no Earth, no Souls, no

*Doubts and
Solutions.*

Bodies; and then why not, that I *my self am not*? Yet surely if I could persuade my self any thing, *I was*.

But there is I know not what sort of *Deceivour* very *powerful* and very *crafty*, who always strives to *deceive* Me; without Doubt therefore *I am*, if he can *decieve me*; And let him *Deceive* me as much as he can, yet he can never make me *not to Be*, whilst *I think that I am*. Wherefore I may lay this down as a *Principle*, that *whenever this sentence I am, I exist, is spoken or thought of by Me, 'tis necessarily True*.

But I do not yet fully understand *who I am* that now necessarily exist, and I must hereafter take care, least I foolishly *mistake* some other thing *for my self*, and by that means be *deceived* in that thought, which I defend as the most *certain* and *evident* of all.

Wherefore I will again Recollect, what I believed *my self to be* heretofore, before I had set upon these Meditations, from which *Notion* I will withdraw whatever may be *Disproved* by the *Foremention'd Reasons*, that in the End, *That only may Remain which is True and indisputable*.

What therefore have I heretofore thought my self? A *Man*. But what is a man? Shall I answer, a *Rational Animal*? By no means; because afterwards it may be asked, what an *Animal* is? and what *Rational* is? And so from one *question* I may fall into greater *Difficulties*; neither at present have I so much time as to spend it about such Niceties.

But I shall rather here Consider, what heretofore represented it self to my thoughts *freely*, and *naturally*, whenever I set my self to understand *What I my self was*.

And the first thing I find Representing it self is, that I have *Face, Hands, Arms*, and this whole *frame of parts* which is seen in my *Body*, and which I call my *Body*.

The next thing represented to me was, that I was *nourish'd*, could *walk*, had *senses*, and could *Think*; which functions I attributed to my *Soul*. Yet what this *soul* of mine was, I did not fully conceive; or else supposed it a small thing like *wind*, or *fire*, or *aire*, infused through my *stronger parts*.

As to my *Body* truly I doubted not, but that I rightly understood its *Nature*, which (if I should endeavour to describe as I conceive it) I should thus Explain, viz. By a *Body* I mean whatever is *capable of Shape*, or can be

contained in a *place*, and so fill's a space that it excludes all other *Bodys* out of the same, that which may be *touch'd*, *seen*, *heard*, *tasted*, or *smelt*, and that which is *capable* of various *Motions* and *Modifications*, not from it *self*, but from any *other thing* moving it, for *I* judged it *against* (or rather *above*) the *nature* of a *Body* to *move it self*, or *perceive*, or *think*, But rather admired that *I* should find these *Operations* in certain *Bodys*.

But How now (since *I* suppose a certain *powerful* and (if it be lawful to call him so) *evil deluder*, who useth all his endeavours to deceive me in all things) can *I* affirme that I have any of those things, which I have now said belong to the *nature* of a *Body*? Hold— Let me Consider—, Let me think —, Let me reflect— I can find no Answer, and I am weary with repeating the same things over-again in vain.

But Which of these *Faculties* did I attribute to my *Soul*, my *Nutritive*, or *Motive faculty*? yet now seeing I have no *Body*, these also are *meer delusions*. Was it my *sensitive faculty*? But this also cannot be perform'd without a *Body*, and I have seem'd to *perceive* many things in my *sleep*, of which I afterwards understood my self *not* to be *sensible*. Was it my *Cogitative Faculty*? Here I have discovered it, 'tis my *Thought*, this alone cannot be separated from Me, *I am*, *I exist*, *tis true*, but for what time *Am I*? Why *I am* as long as *I think*; For it May be that When I cease from *thinking*, I may cease from being. Now I admit of nothing but what is necessarily true: In short therefore I *am* only a *thinking thing* that is to say, a *mind*, or a *soul*, or *understanding*, or *Reason*, words which formerly *I* understood not; I am a *Real thing*, and *Really Existent*, But what sort of thing? I have just now said it, *A thinking thing*.

But am I nothing besides? I will consider I am not that *structure* of *parts*, which is called a Mans *Body*, neither am I any sort of *thin Air* infused into those Parts, nor a *Wind*, nor *Fire*, nor *Vapour*, nor *Breath*, nor whatever I my self can feign, for all these things I have supposed *not to Be*. Yet my Position stands firm; *Nevertheless I am something*. Yet perhaps it so falls out that these very things which I suppose not to exist (because to me *unknown*) are in reallity nothing *different* from that very *Self*, which I *know*. I cannot tell, I dispute it not now, I can only give my opinion of those things whereof I have some knowledge. I am sure that I exist, I ask who I am whom I thus know, certainly, the knowledge, of

* Places noted with their Asterisk are refer'd to in the following Objections.

Me (precisely taken) depends not on those things, whose existence I am yet ignorant of; and therefore not on any other things that I can *feign* by my *imagination*.

And this very Word (*feign*) puts me in mind of my *error*, for I should *feign* in deed, if I should *imagine* my self any thing; for to *imagine* is nothing else but to think upon the *shape* or *image* of a *corporeal* thing; but now I certainly know that I *am*, and I know also that 'tis possible that all these *images*, and generally whatever belongs to the *Nature* of a *Body* are nothing but *deluding Dreams*. Which things Consider'd I should be no less Foolish in saying, *I will imagine that I may more thoroughly understand what I am*, then if I should say, *at Present I am awake and perceive something true, but because it appears not evidently enough, I shall endeavour to sleep, that in a Dream I may perceive it more evidently and truly*.

Wherefore I know that nothing that I can comprehend by my *imagination*, can belong to the *Notion* I have of *my self*, and that I must carefully withdraw my mind from those things that it may more *distinctly* perceive its own *Nature*.

Let me ask therefore *What I am, A Thinking Thing*, but What is That? That is a thing, *doubting, understanding, affirming, denying, willing, nilling, imagining* also, and *sensitive*. These truly are not a few *Properties*, if they all belong to Me. And Why should they Not belong to me? For am not I the very same who at present *doubt* almost of All things; yet *understand* something, which thing onely I *affirm* to be true, I *deny* all other things, I am *willing* to know more, I *would not* be deceived, I *imagine* many things *unwillingly*, and *consider* many things as coming to me by my *senses*. Which of all these faculties is it, which is not as *true* as that I *Exist*, tho I should *sleep*, or my *Creatour* should as much as in him lay, strive to *deceive* Me? which of them is it that is *distinct* from my *thought*? which of them is it that can be *seperated* from *me*? For that I am the same that *doubt, understand, and will* is so *evident*, that I know not how to explain it more *manifestly*, and that I also am the same that *imagine*, for tho perhaps (as I have supposed) no thing that can be *imagined* is *true*, yet the *imaginative Power* it self is *really* existent, and makes up a part of my *Thought*; and last of all that I am the same that am *sensitive, or perceive corporeal* things as by my *senses*, yet that I now *see light, hear a noise, feel heat*, these things

are false, for I suppose my self *asleep*, but I *know* that I *see*, *hear*, and am *heated*, that cannot be *false*; and this it is that in me is *properly* called *Sense*, and this strictly taken is the same with *thought*.

By these Considerations I begin a little better to *understand My self* what I am; But yet it *seems*, and I cannot but *think* that *Corporeal Things* (whose *Images* are formed in my *thought*, and which by my *senses*, I perceive) are much more *distinctly known*, then that *confused Notion* of *My Self* which *imagination* cannot afford me. And yet 'tis strange that things *doubtful*, *unknown*, *distinct from Me*, should be *apprehended* more *clearly* by *Me*, then a Thing that is *True*, then a thing that is *known*, or then *I my self*; But the Reason is, that my Mind loves to wander, and suffers not it self to be bounded within the strict limits of *Truth*.

Let it therefore Wander, and once more let me give it the Free Reins, that hereafter being conveniently curbed, it may suffer it self to be more easily Govern'd.

Let me consider those things which of all Things I formerly conceived most *evident*, that is to say, *Bodies* which we touch, which we see, not bodies in General (for those *General* Conceptions are usually *Confused*) but some one *Body* in particular.

Let us chuse for example this piece of *Bees-wax*, it was lately taken from the *Comb*, it has not yet lost all the *tast* of the *Honey*, it retains something of the *smell* of the *Flowers* from whence 'twas gather'd, its *colour*, *shape*, and *bigness* are manifest, 'tis *hard*, 'tis *cold*, 'tis *easily felt*, and if you will knock it with your finger, 'twill *make a noise*: In fine, it hath all things requisite to the most perfect notion of a *Body*.

But behold whilst I am speaking, 'tis put to the Fire, its *tast* is purged away, the *smell* is vanish'd, the *colour* is changed, the *shape* is alter'd, its *bulk* is increased, its become *soft*, 'tis *hot*, it can scarce be *felt*, and now (though you strike it) it makes no *noise*. Does it yet continue the same Wax? surely it does, this all confess, no one denies it, no one doubts it. What therefore was there in it that was so evidently known? surely none of those things which I *perceived* by my *senses*; for what I *smelt*, *tasted*, have *seen*, *felt*, or *heard*, are all *vanish'd*, and yet the *Wax remains*. Perhaps 'twas this only that I now think on, viz. that the *Wax* it self was not that *tast of Honey*, that *smell of Flowers*, that *whiteness*, that *shape*, or that *sound*, but it was a

Body which awhile before appear'd to me so and so *modified*, but now *otherwise*. But what is it strictly that I thus imagine? let me consider: And having rejected whatever belongs not to the Wax, let me see what will remain, viz. this only, a *thing extended, flexible, and mutable*. But what is this *flexible, and mutable*? is it that I *imagine* that this Wax from being *round* may be made *square*, or from being *square* can be made *triangular*? No, this is not it; for I conceive it capable of *innumerable* such *changes*, and yet I cannot by my *imagination* run over these *Innumerables*; Wherefore this notion of its *mutability* proceeds not from my *imagination*. What then is *extended*? is not its *Extension* also *unknown*? For when it *melts* 'tis *greater*, when it *boils* 'tis *greater*, and yet *greater* when the heat is increas'd; and I should not rightly judge of the Wax, did I not think it capable of more various *Extensions* than I can *imagine*. It remains therefore for me only to confess, that I cannot *imagine* what this Wax is, but that I *perceive* with my *Mind* what it is. I speak of this *particular* Wax, for of Wax in *general* the *notion* is more *clear*.

But what Wax is this that I only conceive by my mind? 'Tis the same which I see, which I touch, which I imagine, and in fine, the same which at first I judged it to be. But this is to be noted, that the *perception* thereof is not *sight*, the *touch*, or the *imagination* thereof; neither was it ever so, though at first it seem'd so. But the *perception* thereof is the *inspection* or *beholding* of the Mind only, which may be either *imperfect* and *confused*, as formerly it was; or *clear* and *distinct*, as now it is; the *more* or the *less* I consider the Composition of the Wax.

In the interim, I cannot but admire how prone my mind is to erre; for though I revolve these things with my self *silently*, and *without speaking*, yet am I intangled in *meer words*, and am almost deceived by the usual way of *expression*; for we commonly say, *that we see the Wax it self if it be present*, and not, *that we judge it present by its colour or shape*; from whence I should immediately thus conclude, therefore the Wax is known by the *sight* of the *eye*, and not by the *inspection* of the *mind* only. Thus I should have concluded, had not I by chance look'd out of my window, and seen men passing by in the Street; which men I as usually say that I *see*, as I do now, that I *see* this Wax; and yet I see nothing but their Hair and Garments, which perhaps may cover only *artificial Machines* and *movements*, but I judge them to be men; so that what I thought I only saw

with my eyes, I comprehend by my *Judicative Faculty*, which is *my Soul*. But it becomes not one, who desires to be wiser than the Vulgar, to draw matter of *doubt* from those ways of *expression*, which the Vulgar have invented.

Wherefore let us proceed and consider, whether I perceived more *perfectly* and *evidently* what the Wax was, when I first look'd on't, and believed that I knew it by my outward *senses*, or at least by my *common sense* (as they call it) that is to say, *by my imagination*; or whether at present I *better understand* it, after I have more diligently enquired both *what it is*, and how it may be *known*. Surely it would be a foolish thing to make it matter of doubt to know which of these parts are true; What was there in my first *perception* that was *distinct*? What was there that seem'd not incident to every other Animal? But now when I distinguish the Wax from its outward adherents, and consider it as if it were naked, with it's coverings pull'd off, then I cannot but really perceive it with my mind, though yet perhaps my judgment may erre.

But what shall I now say as to my *mind*, or my *self*? (for as yet I admit nothing as belonging to me but a *mind*.) Why (shall I say?) should not I, who seem to perceive this Wax so *distinctly*, know my *self* not only more *truly* and more *certainly*, but more *distinctly* and *evidently*? For if I judge that *this Wax exists*, because I *see* this Wax; surely it will be much more *evident*, that I *my self exist*, because I *see this Wax*; for it may be that this that I see is not really Wax, also it may be that I have no eyes wherewith to see any thing; but it cannot be, when I *see*, or (which is the same thing) when I *think that I see*, that I who *think* should not *exist*. The same thing will follow if I *judge that this Wax exists*, because I *touch*, or *imagine* it, &c. And what has been said of Wax, may be apply'd to all other outward things.

Moreover, if the *notion* of Wax seems more *distinct* after it is made known to me, not only by my *sight* or *touch*, but by more and other causes; How much the more *distinctly* must I confess my *self known* unto my *self*, seeing that all sort of reasoning which furthers me in the *perception* of Wax, or any other *Body*, does also encrease the proofs of the *nature* of my *Mind*. But there are so many more things in the very *Mind* it self, by which the *notion* of it may be made more *distinct*, that those things which drawn from *Body* conduce to its knowledge are scarce to be *mention'd*.

And now behold of my own accord am I come to the place I would be in; for seeing I have now discover'd that *Bodies themselves* are not *properly perceived* by our *senses* or *imagination*, but only by our *understanding*, and are not therefore *perceived*, because they are *felt* or *seen*, but because they are *understood*; it plainly appears to me, that nothing can possibly be *perceived by me easier*, or more *evidently*, than my *Mind*.

But because I cannot so soon shake off the Acquaintance of my former Opinion, I am willing to stop here, that this my new knowledge may be better fixt in my memory the longer I meditate thereon.

MEDITAT. III.

Of GOD, and that there is a God.

Now will I shut my eyes, I will stop my ears, and withdraw all my senses, I will blot out the Images of *corporeal* things clearly from my mind, or (because that can scarce be accomplish'd) I will give no heed to them, as being *vain* and *false*, and by discoursing with my self, and prying more rightly into my own Nature, will endeavour to make my self by degrees more known and familiar to my self.

I am a *Thinking Thing*, that is to say, *doubting*, *affirming*, *denying*, *understanding* few things, *ignorant* of many things, *willing*, *nilling*, *imagining* also, and *sensitive*. For (as before I have noted) though perhaps whatever I *imagine*, or am sensible of, as without me, *Is not*; yet that *manner of thinking* which I call *sense* and *imagination* (as they are only certain *Modes of Thinking*) I am certain are in Me. So that in these few Words I have mention'd whatever I *know*, or at least Whatever as yet I *perceive* my self to *know*.

Now will I look about me more carefully to see Whether there Be not some other Thing in Me, of Which I have not yet taken Notice. I am sure That I am a *Thinking Thing*, and therefore Do not I know what is Required to make *certain* of any Thing? I Answer, that in this My *first knowledge* 'tis Nothing but a *clear*, and *distinct perception* of What I affirm, Which would not be sufficient to make me *certain* of the *Truth* of a Thing, if it were *Possible* that any thing that I so *clearly* and *distinctly* Perceive should be *false*. Wherefore I may lay this Down as a *Principle*. *Whatever I Clearly and Distinctly perceive is certainly True*.

But I have formerly Admitted of many Things as very *Certain* and *manifest*, Which I afterwards found to be *doubtful*. Therefore What sort of Things were they? *Viz.* Heaven, Earth, Stars, and all other things which I perceived by my *Senses*. But What did I Perceive of These *Clearly*? *Viz.* That I had the *Ideas* or *Thoughts* of these things in my mind, and at Present I cannot deny that I have these *Ideas* in Me. But there was some other thing Which I affirm'd, and Which (by Reason of the common Way of Belief) I

thought that I *Clearly* Perceived; Which nevertheless, I did not really Perceive; And that was, that there were Certain Things *Without Me* from whence these *Ideas Proceeded*, and to which they were exactly like. And this it was, Wherein I was either *Deceived*, or if by Chance I Judged *truly*, yet it Proceeded not from the strength of my *Perception*.

But When I was exercised about any single and easie Proposition in Arithmetick or Geometry, as that two and three added make five, Did not I Perceive them *Clearly* enough to make me affirm them True? Truly concerning these I had no other Reason afterwards to *Doubt*, but That I thought Perhaps there may be a *God* who might have so created me, that I should be *Deceived* even in those things which seem'd most *Clear* to me. And as often as this Pre-conceived opinion of *Gods great Power* comes into my Mind, I cannot but Confess that he may easily cause me to Err even in those things which I Think I perceive most *Evidently* with my Mind; yet as often as I Consider the Things themselves, which I Judge my self to perceive so *Clearly*, I am so fully Perswaded by them, that I easily Break out into these Expressions, Let Who can Deceive Me, yet he shall never Cause me *Not to Be* whilst *I think that I Am*, or that it shall ever be True, *that I never was*, Whilst at Present 'tis True *that I am*, or Perhaps, that Two and Three added make More or Less then Five; for in These things I Percieve a Manifest Repugnancy; And truly seeing I have no reason to Think any *God* a *Deceiver*, Nor as yet fully know Whether there Be *any God*, or *Not*, 'Tis but a slight and (as I may say) Metaphysical Reason of Doubt, which depends only on that opinion of which I am not yet Perswaded.

Wherefore That this Hindrance may be taken away, When I have time I ought to Enquire, Whether there *Be a God*, And if there be One, Whether he can be a *Deceiver*, For whilst I am *Ignorant* of this, I cannot possibly be fully *Certain* of any Other thing.

But now Method seems to Require Me to Rank all My Thoughts under certain Heads, and to search in Which of them *Truth* or *Falshood* properly Consists. Some of them are (as it were) the *Images* of Things, and to these alone the Name of an *Idea* properly belongs, as When I think upon a Man, A Chimera or Monster, Heaven, an Angel, or *God*. But there are others of them, that have *superadded Forms* to them, as when I Will, when I Fear, when I Affirm, when I Deny. I know I have alwayes (when ever I think)

some certain Thing as the *subject* or *object* of my Thought, but in this last sort of thoughts there is something *more* which I Think upon then Barely the likeness of the Thing. And of these Thoughts some are called *Wills* and *Affections*, and Others of them *Judgments*.

Now as touching *Ideas*, if they be Consider'd alone as they are in themselves, without *Respect* to any other Things, they cannot Properly be *false*; for Whether I *Imagine* a Goat or a Chimera, 'tis as *Certain* that I *Imagine* one as t'other. Also in the *Will* and *Affections* I need not Fear any *Falshood*, For tho I should *Wish* for *evil Things*, or Things that are Not, it is not therefore *Not true* that I Wish for them.

Wherefore there onely Remains my *Judgments* of Things, in which I must take Care that I be not *deceived*. Now the Chief and most usual *Error* that I discover in them is, That I *Judge* Those *Ideas* that are *within* me to be *Conformable* and like to certain things that are *without* Me; for truely if I Consider those *Ideas* as certain *Modes* of my *Thought*, without *Respect* to any other Thing, they will scarce afford me an Occasion of *Erring*.

Of these *Ideas* some are *Innate*, some *Adventitious*, and some Others seem to Me as Created by my self; For that I understand what *A Thing* Is, What is *Truth*, What a *Thought*, seems to Proceed meerly from my own *Nature*. But that I now *hear* a Noise, *see* the Sun, or *feel* heat, I have alwayes *Judged* to Proceed from Things *External*. But Lastly, Mermaids, Griffins, and such like Monsters, are *made meerly* by *My self*. And yet I may well think all of them either *Adventitious*, or all of them *Innate*, or all of them *made by my self*, for I have not as yet discover'd their true *Original*.

But I ought cheifly to search after those of them which I count *Adventitious*, and which I consider as coming from *outward objects*, that I may know what reason I have to think them *like* the things themselves, which they *represent*. Viz. *Nature so teaches Me*; and also I know that they *depend* not on my *Will*, and therefore *not on me*; for they are often present with me against my inclinations, or (as they say) in spite of my teeth, as now whether I *will* or *no* I feel heat, and therefore I think that the *sense* or *Idea* of heat is propagated to me by a *thing* really *distinct* from *my self*, and that is by the *heat* of the *Fire* at which I sit; And nothing is more obvious then for me to judge that That thing should transmit its own *Likeness* into

me, rather than that any other thing should be transmitted by it. Which sort of arguments whether firme enough or not I shall now Trie.

When I here say, that *nature so teaches me*, I understand only, that I am as it were *willingly forced* to beleive it, and not that 'tis *discover'd* to me to be *true* by any *natural light*; for these two differ very much. For whatever is discover'd to me by the *Light of nature* (as that it necessarily Follows *that I am*, because *I think*) cannot possibly be *doubted*; Because I am endowed with no other *Faculty*, in which I may put so great confidence, as I can in the *Light of nature*; or *which* can possibly tell me, that those things are *false*, which *natural light* teaches me to be *true*; and as to my *natural Inclinations*, I have heretofore often judged my self led by them to the election of the *worst part*, when I was in the choosing *one* of two Goods; and therefore I see no reason why I should ever *trust* them in any other thing.

And then, tho these *Ideas depend not* on my *will*, it does not therefore follow that they *necessarily proceed* from *things external*. For as, Altho those *Inclinations* (which I but now mention'd) are in me, yet they seem *distinct* and *different* from my *will*; so perhaps there may be in me some other *faculty* (to me *unknown*) which may prove the *Efficient cause* of these *Ideas*, as hitherto I have observed them to be formed in me whilst I *dream*, without the help of any *External Object*.

And last of all, tho they should *proceed* from things which are *different* from me, it does not therefore follow that they must be *like* those things. For often times I have found the *thing* and the *Idea differing* much. As for example, I find in my self two divers *Ideas* of the Sun, *one* as *received* by my *senses* (and which cheifly I reckon among those I call adventitious) by which it appears to me very *smal*, * *another* as taken from the arguments of Astronomers (that is to say, *consequentially collected*, or some other ways made by me from certain *natural notions*) by which 'tis rendred something bigger then the Globe of the Earth. Certainly both of these cannot be *like* that sun which is *without me*, and my reason perswades me, that that *Idea* is most *unlike* the Sun, which seems to *proceed Immediately* from it self.

All which things sufficiently prove, that I have hitherto (not from a *true judgement*, but from a *blind impulse*) beleived that there are certain things

different from my self, and which have sent their *Ideas* or *Images* into me by the Organs of my *senses*, or some other way.

But I have yet an other Way of inquiring, whether any of those Things (whose *Ideas* I have *within* Me) are Really Existent *without* Me; And that is Thus: As those *Ideas* are only *Modes* of *Thinking*, I acknowledge no *Inequality* between them, and they all proceed from me in the *same Manner*. But as *one* Represents *one thing*, an *other*, an *other Thing*, 'tis Evident there is a *Great difference* between them. * For without doubt, Those of them which Represent *Substances* are something *More*, or (as I may say) have *More* of *Objective Reallity* in them, then those that Represent only *Modes* or *Accidents*; and again, *That* by Which I understand a *Mighty God*, *Eternal*, *Infinite*, *Omniscient*, *Omnipotent Creatour* of all things besides himself, has certainly in it *more Objective Reallity*, then Those *Ideas* by which *Finite Substances* are Exhibited.

But Now, it is evident by the *Light of Nature* that there must be *as much* at least in the *Total efficient Cause*, as there is in the *Effect* of *that Cause*; For from Whence can the *effect* have its *Reallity*, but from the *Cause*? and how can the *Cause* give it that *Reallity*, unless *it self* have it?

And from hence it follows, that neither a *Thing* can be made out of *Nothing*, Neither a Thing which is *more Perfect* (that is, Which has in it self *more Reallity*) proceed from That Which is *Less Perfect*.

And this is *Clearly True*, not only in those *Effects* whose *Actual* or *Formal Reallity* is Consider'd, But in Those *Ideas* also, Whose *Objective Reallity* is only Respected; That is to say, for Example of Illustration, it is not only impossible that a stone, Which *was not*, should now begin to *Be*, unless it were produced by *something*, in Which, Whatever goes to the Making a Stone, is either *Formally* or *Virtually*; neither can *heat* be Produced in any Thing, which before was *not hot*, but by a Thing which is at least of as equal a *degree of Perfection* as *heat* is; But also 'tis Impossible that I should have an *Idea* of Heat, or of a *Stone*, unless it were put into me by some *Cause*, in which there is at Least as much *Reallity*, as I Conceive there is in heat or a Stone. For tho that *Cause* transfers none of its own *Actual* or *Formal Reality* into my *Idea*, I must not from thence conclude that 'tis *less real*; but I may think that the *nature* of the *Idea* it self is such, that of it self it requires no other *formal reality*, but what it has from my

thought, of which 'tis a *mode*. But that this Idea has *this* or *that objective reallity*, rather than any *other*, proceeds clearly from some *cause*, in which there ought to be at least as much *formal reallity*, as there is of *objective reallity* in the *Idea* it self. For if we suppose any thing in the *Idea*, which was not in its *cause*, it must of necessity have this from *nothing*; but (tho it be a most *Imperfect manner* of *existing*, by which the thing is *objectively* in the *Intellect* by an *Idea*, yet) it is not *altogether nothing*, and therefore cannot proceed from *nothing*.

Neither ought I to doubt, seeing the *reallity* which I perceive in my *Ideas* is only an *objective reallity*, that therefore it must of necessity follow, that the same *reallity* should be in the *causes* of these *Ideas formally*. But I may conclude, that 'tis sufficient that this *reallity* be in the very *causes* only *objectively*. For as that *objective manner* of *being* appertains to the very *nature* of an *Idea*, so that *formal manner* of *being* appertains to the very *nature* of a *cause* of *Ideas*, at least to the *first* and *chiefest causes* of them; For tho perhaps one *Idea* may receive its birth from an other, yet we cannot proceed in *Infinitum*, but at last we must arrive at some *first Idea*, whose *cause* is (as it were) an *Original copy*, in which all the *objective reallity* of the *Idea* is *formally contain'd*. So that I plainly discover by the *light of nature*, that the *Ideas*, which are in me, are (as it were) *Pictures*, which may easily *come short* of the *perfection* of those things from whence they are taken, but cannot *contain* any thing *greater* or *more perfect* then them: And the *longer* and *more diligently* I pry into these things, so much the more *clearly* and *distinctly* do I discover them to be *true*.

But what shall I conclude from hence? Thus, that if the *objective reallity* of any of my *Ideas* be *such*, that it cannot be in me either *formally* or *eminently*, and that therefore I cannot be the *cause* of *that Idea*, from hence it necessarily Follows, that *I alone* do not only *exist*, but that some other thing, which is *cause* of that *Idea*, does *exist also*.

But if I can find no *such Idea* in me, I have no argument to perswade me of the *existence* of any thing besides my self for I have diligently enquired, and hitherto I could discover no other *perswasive*.

Some of these *Ideas* there are (besides that which represents *my self* to *my self*, of which in this place I cannot doubt) which represent to me, one of them a *God*, others of them *Corporeal* and *Inanimate* things, some of them

Angels, others *Animals*, and lastly some of them which exhibite to me *men like my self*.

As touching those that represent *Men* or *Angels* or *Animals*, I easily understand that they may be *made up* of those *Ideas* which I have of *my self*, of *Corporeal* things, and of *God*, tho there were neither *man* (but my self) nor *Angel*, nor *Animal* in being.

And as to the *Ideas* of *Corporeal* things, I find nothing in them of that *perfection*, but it may proceed from my self; for if I look into them more narrowly, and examine them more particularly, as yesterday (*in the second Medit.*) I did the *Idea* of Wax, I find there are but few things which I perceive *clearly* and *distinctly* in them, viz. *Magnitude* or *extension* in *Longitude*, *Latitude*, and *Profundity*, the *Figure* or *shape* which arises from the *termination* of that *Extension*, the *Position* or *place* which divers *Figured Bodies* have in *respect* of each other, their *motion* or *change of place*; to which may be added, their *substance*, *continuance*, and *number*; as to the other, such as are, *Light*, *Colours*, *Sounds*, *Smels*, *Tasts*, *Heat*, and *Cold*, with the other *tactile qualities*, I have but very *obscure* and *confused thoughts* of them, so that I know not, whether they are *true* or *false*, that is to say, whether the *Ideas* I have of them are the *Ideas* of *things* which *really are*, or *are not*. For altho *falsehood formally* and *properly* so called, consists only in the *judgement* (as before I have observed) yet there is an other sort of *material falsehood* in *Ideas*, when they represent a *thing* as *really existent*, tho it does *not exist*; so, for example, the *Ideas* I have of *heat* and *cold* are so *obscure* and *confused*, that I cannot collect from them, whether *cold* be a *privation* of *heat*, or *heat* a *privation* of *cold*, or whether either of them be a *real quality*, or whether neither of them be *real*. And since every *Idea* must be *like* the thing it represents, if it be *true* that *cold* is nothing but the *privation* of *heat*, that *Idea* which represents it to me as a thing *real* and *positive* may deservedly be called *false*. The same may be apply'd to other *Ideas*.

And now I see no necessity why I should assigne any other *Author* of these *Ideas* but *my self*; for if they are *false*, that is, represent things that *are not*, I know by the *light* of *nature* that they proceed from *nothing*; that is to say, I harbour them upon no other account, but because my *nature* is *deficient* in something, and *imperfect*. But if they are *true*, yet seeing I

discover so little *reality* in them, that that very *reality* scarce seems to be *really*, I see no reason why I my self should not be the *Author* of them.

But also some of those very *Ideas* of *Corporeal* things which are *clear* and *distinct*, I may seem to have borrow'd from the *Idea* I have of *my self*, viz. *Substance*, *duration*, *number*, and the like; For when I conceive a *stone* to be a *substance* (that is, *a thing apt of it self to exist*) and also that I *my self* am a *substance*, tho I conceive *my self* a *thinking substance* and *not extended*, and the *stone* an *extended substance* and *not thinking*, by which there is a great *diversity* between both the *conceptions*, yet they *agree* in this, that they are *both substances*. So when I conceive my self as *now* in being, and also remember, that *heretofore* I *have been*; and since I have *divers* thoughts, which I can *number* or *count*; from hence it is that I come by the notions of *duration* and *number*; which afterwards I apply to other things.

As to those other things, of which the *Idea* of a *body* is made up, as *extension*, *figure*, *place* and *motion*, they are not *formally* in me, seeing I am only a *thinking thing*; yet seeing they are only certain *modes* of *substance*, and I my self also am a *substance*, they may seem to be in me *eminently*.

* Wherefore there only Remains the *Idea* of a *God*, wherein I must consider whether there be not something included, which cannot possibly have its *original* from me. By the word *God*, I mean a certain *Infinite Substance*, *Independent*, *Omniscient*, *Almighty*, by whom both I *my self*, and every thing else that is (if any thing do *Actually exist*) was created. All which *Attributes* are of such an *high nature*, that the more attentively I consider them, the less I conceive my self possible to be the *Author* of these notions.

From what therefore has been said I must conclude that there is a *God*; for tho the *Idea* of *substance* may arise in me, because that I my self am a *substance*, yet I could not have the *Idea* of an *Infinite substance* (seeing I my self am *finite*) unless it proceeded from a *substance* which is *really Infinite*. Neither ought I to think that I have no *true Idea* of *Infinity*, or that I perceive it only by the *negation* of what is *finite*, as I conceive *rest* and *darkness* by the *negation* or *absence* of *motion* or *light*. But on the contrary I plainly understand, that there is *more reality* in an *Infinite substance*, then in a *Finite*; and that therefore the *perception* of an *Infinite* (as *God*) is *antecedent* to the *notion* I have of a *finite* (as *my self*). For how should I

know that I *doubt* or *desire*, that is to say, that I *want* something, and that I am *not altogether perfect*, unless I had the *Idea* of a *being more perfect* than *my self*, by *comparing* my self to which I may discover my own *Imperfections*.

Neither can it be said that this *Idea* of *God* is *false Materialiter*, and that therefore it *proceeds* from *nothing*, as before I observed of the *Ideas* of *heat* and *cold*, &c. For on the contrary, seeing this *notion* is most *clear* and *distinct*, and contains in it self more *objective reality* than any other *Idea*, none can be more *true* in it self, nor in which less *suspicion* of *falsehood* can be found. This *Idea* (I say) of a *being infinitely perfect* is most *true*, for tho it may be supposed that such a *being* does *not exist*, yet it cannot be supposed that the *Idea* of such a *being* exhibites to me nothing *real*, as before I have said of the *Idea* of *cold*. This *Idea* also is most *clear* and *distinct*, for whatever I perceive *clearly* and *distinctly* to be *real*, and *true*, and *perfect*, is wholly *contain'd* in this *Idea* of *God*.

Neither can it be objected, that I cannot *comprehend* an *Infinite*, or that there are innumerable other things in *God*, which I can neither *conceive*, nor in the least *think upon*; for it is of the *very nature* of an *Infinite* not to be *apprehendable* by *me* who am *finite*. And 'tis sufficient to me to prove this my *Idea* of *God* to be the most *true*, the most *clear*, and the most *distinct* *Idea* of all those *Ideas* I have, upon this *account*, that I understand that *God* is *not to be understood*, and that I judge that whatever I *clearly* perceive and know *Implies* any *perfection*, as also perhaps other innumerable *perfections*, which I am ignorant of, are in *God* either *formally* or *eminently*.

Doubt. But perhaps *I am* something *more* than I take my self to *be*, and perhaps all these *perfections* which I attribute to *God*, are *potentially* in me, tho at present they do not shew themselves, and break into action. For I am now fully experienced that my *Knowledge* may be *encreased*, and I see nothing that hinders why it may not *encrease* by degrees in *Infinitem*, nor why by my *knowledge* so *encreased* I may not attain to the other *perfections* of *God*; nor lastly, why the *power* or *aptitude* of *having* these *perfections* may not be sufficient to produce the *Idea* of them in *me*.

Solution. But none of these will do; for first, tho it be true that my *Knowledge* is capable of being *increased*, and that many things are in me *potentially*, which *actually* are not, yet none of these go to the making an

Idea of God, in which I conceive nothing *potentially*, for tis a certain argument of *imperfection* that a thing *may be encreased Gradually*. Moreover, tho my knowledge may be *more and more encreased*, yet I know that it can never be *actually Infinite*, for it can never arrive to that *height of perfection*, which admits not of an *higher degree*. But I conceive God to be *actually so Infinite*, that nothing can be *added* to his *perfections*. And lastly, I perceive that the *objective being* of an *Idea* cannot be *produced* only by the *potential being* of a *thing* (which in proper speech is *nothing*) but requires an *actual or formal being* to its *production*.

Of all which forementioned things there is nothing that is not *evident* by the *light of reason* to any one that will diligently consider them. Yet because that (when I am careless, and the *Images of sensible things blind my understanding*) I do not so easily call to mind the reasons, why the *Idea* of a *being more perfect* then *my self* should of necessity proceed from a *being* which is *really more perfect*; It will be requisite to enquire further, whether *I*, who have this *Idea*, can possibly *be*, unless *such a being* did exist. To which end let me aske, *from whence* should I *be*? From *my self*? or from my *Parents*? or from any other thing *less perfect* then *God*? for nothing can be thought or supposed *more perfect*, or *equally perfect* with *God*.

But first, If *I* were from my self, I should neither *doubt*, nor *desire*, nor *want* any thing, for I should have given my self all those *perfections*, of which I have any *Idea*, and consequently I my self should be *God*; and I cannot think that those things I *want*, are to be acquired with *greater difficulty* then those things I *have*; but on the contrary, 'tis manifest, that it were much more *difficult* that *I* (that is, *a substance that thinks*) should *arise* out of *nothing*, then that I should *acquire* the *knowledge* of many things whereof I am *Ignorant*, which is only the *accident* of that *substance*. And certainly if I had that *greater thing* (*viz being*) from my self, I should not have *denied* my self (not only, those things which may be easier acquired, but also) All those things, which I perceived are contain'd in the *Idea* of a *God*; and the reason is, for that no other things *seem* to me to be *more difficultly* done, and certainly if they were *Really more difficult*, they would *seem* more *difficult* to me (if whatever *I have*, I *have* from my self) for in those things I should find my *Power* put to a stop.

Neither can I Evade the force of these Arguments by supposing my self to *have alwaies Been*, what now *I am*, and that therefore I need not seek for

an *Author* of my *Being*. For the *Duration* or *Continuance* of my life may be *divided* into *Innumerable Parts*, each of which does not at all *depend* on the *Other Parts*; Therefore it will not follow, that because *a while ago, I was*, I must of necessity *now Be*. I say, this will not follow, Unless, I suppose some *Cause to Create me* (as it were) *anew* for *this Moment* (that is, *Conserve me*). For 'tis evident to one that Considers the Nature of *Duration*, that the same *Power* and *Action* is requisite to the *Conservation* of a Thing each *Moment* of its *Being*, as there is to the *Creation* of that Thing *anew*, if it did *not exist*. So that 'tis one of those *Principles* which are *Evident* by the *Light* of *Nature*: that the *Act of Conservation* differs only *Ratione* (as the Philosophers term it) from the *Act of Creation*.

Wherefore I ought to ask my self this Question, whether *I*, who *now Am*; have any *Power* to *Cause* my self to *Be hereafter*? (for had I any such *power*, I should certainly *know* of it, seeing I am nothing but a *Thinking Thing*, or at least at present I only treat of that part of me, which is a *Thing* that *Thinks*) to which, I answer, that I can discover no such *Power* in Me; And consequently, I evidently know that *I depend* on some *Other being* *distinct* from *my self*.

But what if *I* say that perhaps this *Being* is not *God*, but that *I* am produced either by my *Parents*, or some other *Causes less perfect* than *God*? In answer to which let me consider (as *I* have said before) that 'tis *manifest* that whatever is in the *effect*, *so much* at least ought to be in the *cause*; and therefore seeing *I* am a thing that *thinks*, and have in me an *Idea* of *God*, it will confessedly follow, that whatever sort of *cause* I assign of my own *Being*, it also must be a *Thinking Thing*, and must have an *Idea* of all those *Perfections*, which I attribute to *God*; Of which *Cause* it may be again Asked, whether it be *from it self*, or from any other *Cause*? If *from it self*, 'tis evident (from what has been said) that it must be *God*; For seeing it has the *Power of Existing of it self*, without doubt it has also the *power* of *actually Possessing* all those *Perfections* whereof it has an *Idea* in it self, that is, all those *Perfections* which I conceive in *God*. But if it Be from an *other Cause*, it may again be asked of that *Cause* whether it be *of it self*, or from an *other*; Till at length We arrive at the *Last Cause* of All, Which will Be *God*. For 'tis evident, that this *Enquiry* will not admit of *Progressus in Infinitum*, especially when at Present I treat not only of that *Cause* which at *first made Me*; But chiefly of that which *conserves* me in this *Instant* time.

Neither can it be supposed that many *partial Causes* have *concurred* to the making Me, and that I received the *Idea* of one of *Gods perfections* from *One* of them, and from an *other* of them the *Idea* of an *other*; and that therefore all these Perfections are to be found *scattered* in the World, but not all of them *Joyn'd* in any one which may Be *God*. For on the contrary, *Unity, Simplicity*, or the *inseparability* of All Gods Attributes is one of the *chief Perfections* which I conceive in Him; and certainly the *Idea* of the *Unity* of the *Divine Perfections* could not be *created* in me by any other *cause*, then by *That*, from whence I have received the *Ideas* of his other *perfections*; For 'tis Impossible to make me conceive these *perfections*, *conjunct* and *inseparable*, unless he should also make me know what *perfections* these are.

Lastly as touching my *having* my *Being* from my *Parents*. Tho whatever Thoughts I have heretofore harbour'd of Them were *True*, yet certainly they *contribute* nothing to my *conservation*, neither proceed I from them as *I am* a *Thing* that *Thinks*, for they have onely *predisposed* that *material Thing*, wherein *I*, that is, *my mind* (which only at present I take for *my self*) *Inhabits*. Wherefore I cannot *now* Question that I am sprung from them. But I must of necessity conclude that because *I am*, and because I have an *Idea* of a *Being most perfect*, that is, of *God*, it evidently follows that *there is a God*.

* Now it only remains for me to examine, how I have received this *Idea* of *God*. For I have neither received it by *means* of *my Senses*, neither comes it to me *without* my *Forethought*, as the *Ideas* of *sensible* things use to do, when such things *Work* on the Organs of my *Sense*, or at least *seem* so to work; Neither is this *Idea* framed by *my self*, for I can neither *detract from*, nor *add* any thing *thereto*. Wherefore I have only to conclude that it is *Innate*, even as the *Idea* of me *my self* is *Natural* to my self.

And truly 'tis not to be Admired that *God* in Creating me should *Imprint* this *Idea* in me, that it may there remain as a *stamp impressed* by the *Workman God* on *me* his *Work*, neither is it requisite that this *stamp* should be a *Thing different* from the *Work* it self, but 'tis very Credible (from hence only that *God Created* me) that I am made as it were according to his *likeness* and *Image*, and that the same *likeness*, in which the *Idea* of *God* is contain'd, is *perceived* by Me with the *same faculty*, with which I *perceive* my *Self*; That is to say, whilst *I reflect* upon my self, *I* do not only *perceive*

that I am an *Imperfect* thing, having my *dependance* upon some other thing, and that I am a Thing that Desires *more* and *better* things *Indefinitely*; But also at the same time I understand, that *He* on whom I *depend* contains in him all those *wish'd for things* (not only *Indefinitely* and *Potentially*, but) *Really, Indefinitely*; and that therefore he is *God*. The whole stress of which [*](#) Argument lies thus, because I know it Impossible for Me to Be of the same Nature I am, *Viz.* Having the *Idea* of a *God* in me, unless really there were a *God*, a *God* (I say) that very *same God*, whose *Idea* I have in my *Mind* (that is, Having all those *perfections*, which I cannot *comprehend*, but can as it were *think upon them*) and who is not *subject* to any *Defects*.

By which 'tis evident that *God* is no *Deceiver*; for 'tis manifest by the *Light of Nature*, that all *fraud* and *deceit* depends on some *defect*. But before I prosecute this any farther, or pry into other *Truthes* which may be deduced from this, I am willing here to stop, and dwell upon the Contemplation of this *God*, to Consider with my self His *Divine Attributes*, to behold, admire, and adore the Loveliness of this *Immense light*, as much as possibly I am able to accomplish with my *dark Understanding*. For as by *Faith* we *believe* that the greatest *happiness* of the *next Life* consists alone in the *Contemplation* of the *Divine Majesty*, so we *find* by *Experience* that now we receive from thence the greatest *pleasure*, whereof we are capable in *this Life*; Tho it be much more *Imperfect* then that in the *Next*.

MEDITAT. IV. *Of Truth and Falshood.*

Of late it has been so common with me to withdraw *my Mind* from my *sences*, and I have so throughly consider'd how few things there are appertaining to *Bodies* that are *truly* perceived, and that there are more Things touching *Mans mind*, and yet more concerning *God*, which are *well known*; that now without any difficulty *I* can turn my Thoughts from things *sensible*, to those which are only *Intelligible*, and *Abstracted* from *Matter*. And truly *I* have a much more *distinct Idea* of a *Mans mind* (as it is a *Thinking Thing*, having no *Corporeal Dimensions* of *Length*, *Breadth*, and *Thickness*, nor having any other *Corporeal Quality*) then the *Idea* of any *Corporeal Thing* can be. And when I reflect upon my self, and consider how that I *doubt*, that is, am an *imperfect dependent Being*, I from hence Collect such a *clear* and *distinct Idea* of an *Independent perfect Being*, which is *God*, and from hence only that *I have such an Idea*, that is, because *I* that have this *Idea* do *my self Exist*; I do so *clearly* conclude that *God also Exists*, and that on him my *Being depends* each Minute; That I am Confident nothing can be known more *Evidently* and *Certainly* by *Humane Understanding*.

And now *I* seem to perceive a *Method* by which, (from this Contemplation of the *true God*, in whom the Treasures of *Knowledge* and *Wisdom* are Hidden) *I* may attain the *Knowledge* of other Things.

And first, *I* know 'tis impossible that this *God* should *deceive* me; For in all *cheating* and *deceit* there is something of *imperfection*; and tho to be *able* to *deceive* may seem to be an Argument of *ingenuity* and *power*, yet without doubt to *have* the *Will* of *deceiving* is a sign of *Malice* and *Weakness*, and therefore is not *Incident* to *God*.

I have also found in my self a *Judicative faculty*, which certainly (as all other things I possess) I have received from *God*; and seeing he will not *deceive* me, he has surely given me such a *Judgement*, that I can *never Err*, whilst I make a *Right Use* of it. Of which truth I can make no doubt, unless it seems, that From hence it will follow, That therefore *I can never Err*; for

if whatever I have, I have from *God*, and if he gave me no *Faculty* of *Erring*, I may seem not to be *able to Err*. And truly so it is whilst I think upon *God*, and wholly convert my self to the *consideration* of him, I find no occasion of *Error* or *Deceit*; but yet when I return to the *Contemplation* of my self, I find my self liable to *Innumerable Errors*. Enquiring into the *cause* of which, I find in my self an *Idea*, not only a *real* and *positive one* of a *God*, that is, of a *Being infinitely perfect*, but also (as I may so speak) a *Negative Idea* of *Nothing*; that is to say, I am so constituted between *God* and *Nothing* or between a perfect *Being* and *No-being*, that as I am *Created* by the *Highest Being*, I have nothing in Me by which I may be *deceived* or drawn into *Error*; but as I partake in a manner of *Nothing*, or of a *No-Being*, that is, as I my self am *not the Highest Being*, and as I want many *perfections*, 'tis no Wonder that I should be *Deceived*.

By which I understand that *Error* * (as it is *Error*) is not any *real Being* dependant on *God*, but it is only a *Defect*; And that therefore to make me *Err* there is not requisite a *faculty* of *Erring* given me by *God*, but only it so happens that I *Err* meerly because the *Judicative faculty*, which he has given me, is not *Infinite*.

But yet this Account is not fully *satisfactory*; for *Error* is not only a meer *Negation*, but 'tis a *Privation*, or a *want* of a certain *Knowledge*, which *ought* (as it were) to be in me. And when I consider the *Nature* of *God*, it seems impossible that he should give me any *faculty* which is not *perfect* in its *kind*, or which should want any of its *due perfections*; for if by how much the more *skilful* the *Workman* is, by so much the *Perfector Works* proceed from him. What can be made by the *Great Maker* of all things which is not *fully perfect*? For I cannot Doubt but *God* may *Create* me so that I may *never* be *deceived*, neither can I doubt but that he *Wills* whatever is *Best*; Is it therefore *better* for me to be *deceived*, or not to be *deceived*?

These things when I Consider more heedfully, it comes into my Mind, First, that 'tis no cause of *Admiration* that *God* should do Things whereof I can give no account, nor must I therefore doubt his *Being*, because there are many things done by him, and I not comprehend *Why* or *How* they are done; for seeing I now know that my *Nature* is very *Weak* and *Finite*, and that the *Nature* of *God* is *Immense*, *Incomprehensible*, *Infinite*; from hence I must fully, understand, that he can do numberless things, the *Causes* whereof lie *hidden* to Me. Upon which account only I esteem all those

Causes which are Drawn from the End (viz. *Final Causes*) as of no use in *Natural Philosophy*, for I cannot without Rashness Think my self *able* to Discover *Gods* Designes.

I perceive this also, that whenever we endeavour to know whether the *Works of God* are *perfect*, we must not Respect any *one kind* of Creature *singly*, but the *Whole Universe of Beings*; for perhaps what (if considered *alone*) may Deservedly seem *Imperfect*, yet (as it is a *part* of the *World*) is most *perfect*; and tho since I have *doubted* of all things, I have discover'd nothing *certainly* to *Exist*, but *my self*, and *God*, yet since I have Consider'd the *Omnipotency* of *God*, I cannot deny, but that many other things *are made* (or at least, *may be made*) by him, so that I my self *may be* a *part* of this *Universe*.

Furthermore, coming nigher to my self, and enquiring what these *Errors* of mine, are (which are the Only Arguments of my *Imperfection*) * I find them to *depend* on *two concurring Causes*, on my *faculty* of *Knowing*, and on my *faculty* of *Choosing* or *Freedom* of my *Will*, that is to say, from my *Understanding*, and my *Will together*. For by my *Understanding alone* I only perceive *Ideas*, whereon I make *Judgments*, wherein (*precisely* so taken) there can be no *Error*, *properly* so called; for tho perhaps there may be numberless things, whose *Ideas* I have *not* in Me, yet I am not *properly* to be said *Deprived* of them, but only *negatively wanting* them; and I cannot prove that *God ought* to have given me a *greater faculty* of *Knowing*. And tho I understand him to be a *skilful Workman*, yet I cannot Think, that he *ought* to have put all those *perfections* in *each Work* of his *singly*, with which he might have *endowed some* of them.

Neither can I complain that *God* has not given me a *Will*, or *Freedom* of *Choise*, *large* and *perfect* enough; for I have experienced that 'tis *Circumscribed* by *no Bounds*.

And 'tis worth our taking notice, that I have no other thing in me so *perfect* and so *Great*, but I Understand that there may be *Perfecter* and *Greater*, for if (for Example) I consider the *Faculty* of *Understanding*, I presently perceive that in me 'tis very *small* and *Finite*, and also at the same time I form to my self an *Idea* of an other *Understanding* not only *much Greater*, but the *Greatest* and *Infinite*, which I perceive to belong to *God*. In the same manner if I enquire into *memory* or *imagination* or any other

faculties, I find them in my self *Weak* and *Circumscribed*, but in God I Understand them to be *Infinite*, there is therefore only my *Will* or *Freedome* of *Choice*, which I find to be so *Great*, that I cannot frame to my self an *Idea* of *One Greater*, so that 'tis by this *chiefly* by which I Understand my self to Bear the *likeness* and *Image* of God. For tho the *Will* in God be without comparison *Greater* then Mine, both as to the *Knowledge* and *Power* which are *Joyn'd* therewith, which make it more *strong* and *Effective*, and also as to the *Object* thereof, for God can apply himself to *more* things then I can. Yet being taken *Formally* and *Precisely* Gods *Will* seems *no greater* then Mine. For the *Freedome* of *Will* consists only in this, that we can *Do*, or *not Do* such a Thing (that is, *affirm* or *deny*, *prosecute* or *avoid*) or rather in this Only, that we are so *carried* to a Thing which is *proposed* by Our *Intellect* to *Affirm* or *Deny*, *Prosecute* or *Shun*, that we are *sensible*, that we are *not Determin'd* to the *Choice* or *Aversion* thereof, by any *outward Force*.

Neither is it Requisite to make one *Free* that he should have an *Inclination* to *both* sides. For on the contrary, by how much the more *strongly* I am inclined to *one* side (whether it be that I *evidently perceive* therein Good or Evil, or Whether it be that *God has so disposed* my *Inward Thoughts*) By so much the *more Free* am I in my *Choice*.

Neither truly do Gods *Grace* or *Natural Knowledge* take away from my *Liberty*, but rather *encrease* and *strengthen* it. For that *indifference* which I find in my self, when no Reason inclines me *more* to *one side*, then to *the other*, is the *meanest* sort of *Liberty*, and is so far from being a sign of *perfection*, that it only argues a *defect* or *negation* of *Knowledge*; for if I should always *Clearly* see what were *True* and *Good* I should never *deliberate* in my *Judgement* or *Choice*, and Consequently, tho I were *perfectly Free*, yet I should never be *Indifferent*.

From all which, I perceive that neither the *Power* of *Willing* *precisely* so taken, which I have from God, is the *Cause* of my *Errors*, it being most *full* and *perfect* in its kind; Neither also the *Power* of *Understanding*, for whatever I *Understand* (since 'tis from God that I *Understand* it) I *understand aright*, nor can I be therein *Deceived*.

From *Whence* therefore proceed all my *Errors*? To which, I answer, that they proceed from *hence* only, that seeing the *Will* expatiates it self *farther*

then the *Understanding*, I keep it not within the *same bounds* with my *Understanding*, but often extend it to those things which I *Understand not*, to which things it being *Indifferent*, it easily Declines from what is *True* and *Good*; and consequently I am *Deceived* and *Commit sin*. * Thus, for example, when lately I felt my self to enquire, Whether any thing doth *Exist*, and found that from my setting *my self* to Examine such a thing, it evidently follows that I *my self Exist*, I could not but *Judge*, what I so *clearly Understood*, to be *true*, not that I was *forced* thereto by any *outward impulse*, but because a *strong Propension* in my *Will* did follow this *Great Light* in my *Understanding*, so that I believed it so much the more *freely* and *willingly*, by how much the less *indifferent* I was thereto. But now I understand, not only, that I *Exist* as I am a *Thing* that *Thinks*, but I also meet with a certain *Idea* of a *Corporeal Nature*, and it so happens that I *doubt*, whether that *Thinking Nature* that is in me be *Different* from that *Corporeal Nature*, or Whether they are *both the same*: but in this I suppose that I have found no Argument to *incline* me *either ways*, and therefore I am *Indifferent* to *affirm* or *deny either*, or to *Judge nothing* of *either*; But this *indifferency* extends it self not only to those things of which I am *clearly ignorant*, but generally to all those things which are *not* so very *evidently known* to me at the Time when my *Will Deliberates* of them; for tho never so probable *Guesses incline* me to *one side*, yet the Knowing that they are only *Conjectures*, and not indubitable *reasons*, is enough to Draw my Assent to the *Contrary Part*. Which Lately I have sufficiently experienced, when I supposed all those things (which formerly I assented to as most *True*) as very *False*, for this *Reason* only that I found my self *able* to doubt of them in some manner.

If I abstain from *passing* my *Judgment*, when I do *not clearly* and *distinctly* enough perceive what is *Truth*, 'tis evident that I do *well*, and that I am *not deceived*: But if I *affirm* or *deny*, then 'tis that I *abuse* the *freedom* of my *will*, and if I turn my self to that part which is *false*, I am *deceived*; but if I *embrace* the *contrary Part*, 'tis but *by chance* that I light on the *Truth*, yet I shall not therefore be Blameless, for 'tis Manifest by the *light* of *Nature* that the *Perception* of the *Understanding* ought to preceed the *Determination* of the *Will*. And 'tis in this *abuse* of *Free-Will* that That *Privation* consists, which Constitutes *Error*; I say there is a *Privation* in the *Action* as it proceeds from Me, but not in the *Faculty* which I have received from God; nor in the *Action* as it *depends* on him.

Neither have I any Reason to Complain that God has not given me a *larger Intellective Faculty*, or more *Natural Light*, for 'tis a necessary Incident to a *finite Understanding* that it should not Understand *All* things, and 'tis Incident to a *Created Understanding* to be *Finite*: and I have more Reason to thank him for what he has *bestowed* upon me (tho he *owed* me nothing) then to think my self *Robbed* by him of those things which he *never gave me*.

Nor have I Reason to Complain that he has given me a *Will* larger then my *Understanding*: for seeing the *Will* Consists in *one* thing only, and as it were in an *Indivisible* (viz. to *Will*, or *not to Will*) it seems contrary to its nature that it should be *less* then 'tis; and certainly by how much the *Greater* it is, so much the more *Thankful* I ought to be to *him*; that Gave it me.

Neither can I Complain that God *concurrs* with me in the Production of those *Voluntary Actions* or *Judgements* in which I am *deceived*: for those *Acts* as they *depend* on God are altogether *True* and *Good*; and I am in some measure *more perfect* in that I can so *Act*, then if I could *not*: for that *Privation*, in which the *Ratio Formalis* of *Falshood* and *Sin* consists, wants not the *Concourse* of God; For it is *not A Thing*, and having respect to him as its *Cause*, ought not to be called *Privation*, but *Negation*; for certainly 'tis no *Imperfection* in God, that he has given me a *freedome* of *Assenting* or *not Assenting* to some things, the *clear* and *distinct* Knowledge whereof he has not *Imparted* to my *Understanding*; but certainly 'tis an *Imperfection* in me, that I *abuse* this *liberty*, and *pass* my *Judgement* on those things which I do *not Rightly* Understand.

Yet I see that 'tis Possible with God to effect that (tho I should remain *Free*, and of a *Finite Knowledge*) I should *never Err*, that is, if he had endowed my *Understanding* with a *clear* and *distinct* Knowledge of all things whereof I should ever have an *Occasion* of *deliberating*; or if he had only so firmly fix'd in my Mind, that I should never forget, this, *That I must never Judge of a thing which I do not clearly and distinctly Understand*; Either of which things had God done, I easily perceive that I (as consider'd in my self) should be *more perfect* then now I am, yet nevertheless I cannot deny but that there *may be a greater perfection* in the *whole Universe* of Things, for that some of its parts are *Obnoxious* to *Errors*, and some not, then if they were all *alike*. And I have no Reason to Complain, that it has

pleased God, that I should *Act* on the *Stage* of this *World* a *Part* not the *chief* and *most perfect* of all; Or that I should not be able to abstain from *Error* in the *first way* above specifi'd, which depends upon the *Evident Knowledge* of those things whereof *I deliberate*; Yet that I may abstain from *Error* by the *other means* abovemention'd, which depends only on this, *That I Judge not of any Thing, the truth whereof is not Evident*. For tho I have experienced in my self this *Infirmity*, that I cannot *always* be intent upon *one* and the *same Knowledge*, yet *I* may by a *continued* and *often repeated* Meditation bring this to pass, that as often as *I* have use of this Rule *I* may Remember it, by which means I may Get (as it were) an *habit* of *not erring*.

In which thing seeing, the *greatest* and *chief perfection* of *Man* consists, *I* repute my self to have gain'd much by this days *Meditation*, for that therein *I* have discover'd the *Cause of Error, and Falshood*; which certainly can be no other then what *I* have now Declared; for whenever in Passing my Judgement, *I* bridle my *Will* so that it extend it self *only* to those things which *I* *clearly* and *distinctly* perceive, it is impossible that *I* can *Err*. For doubtless All *clear* and *distinct* Perception is *something*, and therefore cannot *proceed* from *Nothing*, but must necessarily have *God* for its *Author* (*God*, I say, Who is *infinitely Perfect*, and who *cannot Deceive*) and therefore it Must be *True*.

Nor have I this Day learnt only what I must *beware off* that I be not *deceived*, but also what I must *Do* to Discover *Truth*, for *That* I shall certainly find, if I fully Apply my self to those things *only*, which I *perfectly* understand; and if I distinguish between those and what I apprehend but *confusedly* and *obscurely*; Both which hereafter I shall endeavour.

MEDITAT. V.
Of the Essence of Things Material. And herein
Again of God. And that he does Exist.

There are yet remaining many Things concerning *Gods Attributes*, and many things concerning the *nature of my self* or of my *Mind*, which ought to be searched into: but these perhaps I shall set upon at some other Opportunity. And at Present nothing seems to me more requisite (feeling I have discover'd what I must *avoid*, and what I must *Do* for the *Attaining of Truth*) then that I imploy my Endeavours to free my self from those doubts into which I have lately fallen, and that I try whether I can have any certainty of Material Things.

But before I enquire whether there be any such things *Really Existent without Me*, I ought to consider the *Ideas* of those things, as they are in my Thoughts and try which of them are *Distinct*, which *confused*.

In which search I find that I *distinctly imagine Quantity*, that which Philosophers commonly call *continued*, that is to say, the *Extension* of that *Quantity* or thing *continued* into *Length*, *Breadth*, and *Thickness*, I can count in it divers Parts, to which parts I can assign *Bigness*, *Figure*, *Position*, and *Local Motion*, to which *Local Motion* I can assign *Duration*. Neither are only these *Generals* plainly discover'd and known by Me, but also by attentive Consideration, I perceive Innumerable *particulars* concerning the *Shapes*, *Number*, and *Motion* of These Bodies; The *Truth* whereof is so *evident*, and *agreeable* to my *Nature*, that when I first discover'd them, I seemed not so much to have *Learnt* any thing that is *new*, as to have only *remembred* what I have known *before*, or only to have thought on those things which were in me *before*, tho this be the first time that I have examin'd them so *diligently*.

One thing there is worthy my Consideration, which is, that I find in my self innumerable *Ideas* of certain things, which tho perhaps they *exist no where without Me*, yet they cannot Be said to be *Nothing*; and tho they are *Thought* upon by me at my *will* and *pleasure*, yet they are not *made by Me*,

but have their own *True* and *Immutable Natures*. As when, for example, * I *Imagine* a *Triangle*, tho perhaps such a *Figure Exists no where* out of my *Thoughts*, nor ever will *Exist*, yet the *Nature* thereof is *determinate*, and its *Essence* or *Form* is *Immutable* and *Eternal*, which is neither *made* by me, nor *depends* on my mind, as appears for that many *properties* may be *demonstrated* of this *Triangle*, viz. That its three *Angles* are equal to two right ones, that to its *Greatest Angle* the *Greatest side* is subtended, and such like, which I now *clearly* know whether *I will or not*, tho before I never thought on them, when I *imagine* a *Triangle*, and consequently they could not be invented by Me. And 'tis nothing to the purpose for me to say, that perhaps this *Idea* of a *Triangle* came to me by the *Organs of sense*, because I have sometimes seen bodies of a *Triangular Shape*; for I can think of *Innumerable* other *Figures*, which I cannot suspect to have come in through my *senses*, and yet I can *Demonstrate* various *properties* of them, as well as of a *Triangle*, which certainly are all *true*, seeing I know them *clearly*, and therefore they are *something*, and not a meer *Nothing*, for 'tis Evident that *what is true is something*.

And now I have sufficiently *Demonstrated*, that *what I clearly perceive, is True*; And tho I had *not demonstrated* it, yet such is the *Nature* of my *Mind*, that I could not but give my *Assent* to what I so perceive, at least, as long as I so perceive it; and I remember (heretofore when I most of all relied on *sensible Objects*) that I held those *Truths* for the most *certain* which I *evidently* perceived, such as are concerning *Figures*, *Numbers*, with other parts of *Arithmetick*, and *Geometry*, as also whatever relates to *pure* and *abstracted Mathematicks*.

Now therefore, if from this alone, *That I can frame the Idea of a Thing in my Mind*, it follows, *That whatever I clearly and distinctly perceive belonging to a thing, does Really belong to it*; Cannot I from hence draw an *Argument* to Prove the *Existence* of a *God*? Certainly I find the *Idea* of a *God*, or *infinitely perfect Being*, as *naturally* in me, as the *Idea* of any *Figure*, or *Number*; and I as *clearly* and *distinctly* understand that it appertains to his *Nature Always to Be*, as I know that what I can *demonstrate* of a *Mathematical Figure* or *Number* belongs to the *Nature* of that *Figure* or *Number*: so that, tho all things which I have *Meditated* upon these three or four days were not *true*, yet I may well be as *certain* of the *Existence* of a *God*, as I have hitherto been of *Mathematical Truths*.

Doubt. Yet this Argument at first sight appears not so *evident*, but looks rather like a *sophism*; for seeing I am used in all other things to *Distinguish Existence* from *Essence*, I can easily perswade my self that the *Existence* of *God* may be *distinguish'd* from his *Essence*, so that I may *Imagine God* not to *Exist*.

Solution. But considering it more strictly, 'tis manifest, that the *Existence* of *God* can no more be *seperated* from his *Essence*, then the *Equality* of the *Three Angles* to two *right ones* can be *seperated* from the *Essence* of a *Triangle*, or then the *Idea* of a *Mountain* can be *without* the *Idea* of a *valley*; so that 'tis no less a *Repugnancy* to think of a *God* (that is, A *Being infinitely perfect*) who wants *Existence* (that is, who wants a *Perfection*) then to think of a *Mountain*, to which there is *no Valley adjoining*.

Doubt. But what if I cannot imagine *God* but as *Existing*, or a *Mountain without a Vally*? yet supposing me to think of a *Mountain with a Vally*, it does not from thence follow, that there *Is a Mountain* in the *World*; so supposing me to think of a *God as Existing*, yet does it not follow that *God Really Exists*. For my *Thought imposes no necessity* on *Things*, and as I may imagine a *Winged Horse*, tho no *Horse* has *Wings*, so I may imagine an *existing God*, tho no *God* exist.

Solution. 'Tis true the *Sophism* seems to lie in this, yet tho I cannot conceive a *Mountain* but with a *Vally*, it does not from hence follow, that a *Mountain* or *Vally* do *Exist*, but this will follow, that whether a *Mountain* or a *Vally* do or do not *Exist*, yet they cannot be *seperated*: so from hence that I cannot think of *God* but as *Existing*, it follows that *Existence* is *Inseperable* from *God*, and therefore that he *Really Exists*; Not because my *Thought* does all this, or *Imposes any necessity* on any *Thing*, but contrarily, because the *necessity* of the thing it self (viz. of *Gods Existence*) *Determines* me to *think* thus; for 'tis not in my *Power* to think a *God* without *Existence* (that is, A *Being absolutely perfect* without the *Cheif Perfection*) as it is in my *Power* to imagine a *Horse* either *with* or *without Wings*.

Doubt. And here it cannot be said, that I am forced to suppose *God Existing*, after I have supposed him *endowed* with all *Perfections*, seeing *Existence* is one of them; but that my *First Position* (viz. His *Absolute Perfection*) is not *necessary*. Thus, for example, 'tis not *necessary* for me to think all *Quadrilateral Figures* inscribed in a *Circle*; But supposing that I

think so, I am then *necessitated* to Confess a *Rhombe Incribed* therein, and yet this is evidently *False*.

Solution. For tho I am not forced at any time to think of a *God*; yet as often as I cast my Thoughts on a *First and Cheif Being*, and as it were bring forth out of the Treasury of my Mind an *Idea* thereof, I must of necessity attribute thereto all Manner of *Perfections*, tho I do not at that time *count* them over, or *Remark* each single One; which *necessity* is sufficient to make me hereafter (when I come to consider *Existence* to be a *Perfection*) conclude *Rightly*, *That the First and Chief Being does Exist*. Thus, for example, I am not obliged at any time to imagine a *Triangle*, yet whenever I please to Consider of a *Right-lined Figure* having only *three Angles*, I am then *necessitated* to allow it all those *Requisites* from which I may argue rightly, *That the Three Angles thereof are not Greater then Two Right Ones*, Tho upon the first consideration this came not into my Thought. But when I enquire what Figures may be *inscribed* within a *Circle*, I am not at all *necessitated* to think that all *Quadrilateral Figures* are of that sort; neither can I possibly imagine this, whilst I admit of nothing, but what I *clearly* and *distinctly* Understand: and therefore there is a great Difference between these *False suppositions*, and *True natural Ideas*, the *first* and *Chief*; whereof is that of a *God*; For by many wayes I understand *That* not to be a *Fiction depending* on my *Thought*, but an *Image* of a *True* and *Immutable Nature*; As first, because I can think of no other thing but *God* to Whose *Essence Existence* belongs. Next because I cannot Imagine *Two* or *More Gods*, and supposing that he is *now* only *One*, I may plainly perceive it *necessary* for *Him* to *Have been from Eternity*, and *will Be to Eternity*; And Lastly because I perceive many Other Things in *God*, Which I cannot *Change*, and from which I cannot *Detract*.

But whatever way of Argumentation I use, it comes All at last to this one Thing, That I am fully perswaded of the *Truth* of those things only, which appear to me *clearly* and *distinctly*. And tho some of those things, which I so perceive, are obvious to *every Man*, and some are only discover'd by Those that search more *nighly*, and enquire more *carefully*, yet when such *truths* are discover'd, they are esteem'd no less *certain* than the Others. For Example, Tho it do not so easily appear, that in a Rightangled Triangle, the square of the Base is equal to the squares of the sides, as it appears, that the

Base is suspended under its Largest Angle, yet the *first Proposition* is *no less certainly* believed when once 'tis perceived, then this *Last*.

Thus in Reference to *God*; certainly, unless I am overrun with *Prejudice*, or have my thoughts begirt on all sides with *sensible Objects*, I should acknowledge nothing *before* or *easier* than him; For what is more *self-evident* than that there is a *Chief Being*, or then that a *God* (to whose *essence alone Existence* appertains) does *Exist*? And tho serious Consideration is required to perceive thus much, yet *Now*, I am not only equally *certain* of it, as of what seems most *certain*, but I perceive also that the *Truth* of other Things so *depends* on it, that without it nothing can ever be *perfectly known*.

For tho my *nature* be *such*, that during the time of my *Clear* and *Distinct* Perception, I cannot but believe it *true*; yet my *Nature* is *such* also, that I cannot fix the *Intention* of my *Mind* upon one and the same thing alwayes, so as to perceive it *clearly*, and the Remembrance of what *Judgement* I have formerly made is often stirred up, when I cease attending to those reasons for which I passed such a Judgment, other Reasons may then be produced, which (if I did not *know God*) may easily *move* me in my *Opinion*; and by this means I shall never attain to the *true* and *certain Knowledge* of any Thing, but *Wandering* and *Unstable opinions*. So, for example, when I consider the Nature of a Triangle, it plainly appears to me (as understanding the Principles of Geometry) that its three Angles are equal to two right ones; And this I must of necessity think *True* as long as I attend to the *Demonstration* thereof; but as soon as ever I withdraw my Mind from the *Consideration* of its *Proof* (altho I remember that I have once *Clearly* perceived it) yet perhaps I may *doubt* of Its *Truth*, being as yet *Ignorant* of a *God*; For I may perswade my self, that I am so framed by *Nature*, as to be *deceived* in those things which I imagine my self to perceive most *evidently*, Especially when I recollect, that heretofore I have often accounted many things *True* and *Certain*, which afterward upon other Reasons I have Judged as False. But when I perceive that there is a *God*; because at the same time I also Understand that all things *Depend* on Him, and that he is not a *Deceiver*; and when from hence I Collect that all those Things which I *clearly* and *distinctly* perceive are *necessarily True*; tho I have no further Respects to those Reasons which induced me to believe it *True*, yet if I do but remember, that I have *once clearly* and *distinctly* perceived it, no

Argument can be brought on the contrary, that shall make me *doubt*, but that I have *true* and *certain* Knowledge thereof; and not onely of that, but of all other *Truths* also which I remember that I have *once Demonstrated*, such as are *Geometrical Propositions* and the like.

What now can be *Objected* against me? shall I say, that I am so made by *Nature*, as to be often *deceived*? No; For I now Know that I cannot be *deceived* in those Things, which I *clearly* Understand. Shall I say, that at other times I have esteem'd many Things *True* and *Certain*, which afterwards I found to be *falsities*? No; for I perceived none of those things *clearly* and *distinctly*, but being Ignorant of this *Rule of Truth*, I took them up for Reasons, which Reasons I afterward found to be *Weak*. What then can be said? Shall, I say, (as lately I objected) that Perhaps I am *asleep*, and that what I now think of is no more *True*, then the *Dreams* of People *asleep*? But this it self *moves* not my Opinion; for certainly tho I were *asleep*, if any thing appear'd *evident* to my Understanding, 'twould be *True*.

And Thus I Plainly see, that the *Certainty* and *Truth* of all *Science* Depends on the *Knowledge* of the *True God*, so that before I had *Known Him*, I did *Know nothing*; But now many things both of *God* himself, and of other *Intellectual Things*, as also of *Corporeal nature*, which is the *Object* of *Mathematicks*, may be *Plainly Known* and *Certain* to me.

MEDITAT. VI.
**Of Corporeal Beings, and Their Existence: As Also
of the Real Difference, Between Mind and Body.**

It now remains that I examine whether any *Corporeal Beings* do *Exist*; And already I know that (as they are the *Object of Pure Mathematicks*) they *May* (at least) *Exist*, for I *clearly and distinctly* perceive them; and doubtless *God* is *able to make*, whatever I am *able to perceive*, and I never Judged any thing to be *beyond his Power*, but what was *Repugnant* to a *distinct perception*. Moreover, such *Material Beings* seem to *Exist* from the *faculty of Imagination*, which I find my self make use of, when I am conversant about them: for if I attentively Consider what *Imagination* is, 'twill appear to be only *a certain Application of our Cognoscitive or knowing Faculty to a Body or Object that is before it*; and if it be *before it*, It must *Exist*.

But that this may be made more *Plain*, I must first examine the *difference* between *Imagination*, and *pure Intellection*, or *Understanding*. So, for example, when I *Imagine* a Triangle, I do not only *Understand* that it is a *figure comprehended by three Lines*, but I also *behold* with the eye of my mind those *three lines* as it were *before Me*, and this is that which I call *imagination*. But if I convert my Thoughts to a *Chiliogone*, or *Figure consisting of a Thousand Angles*, I know as well that this Is a *figure comprehended by a Thousand sides*, as I know that a *Triangle* is a *Figure Consisting of three sides*; but I do not in the same Manner *Imagine*, or *behold* as *present* those *thousand sides*, as I do the *three sides* of a *Triangle*. And tho at the time when I so think of a *Chiliogone*, I may *confusedly* represent to my self some *Figure* (because whenever I Think of a *Corporeal Object*, I am used to *Imagine* some *Shape* or other) yet 'tis evident that this *Representation* is not a *Chiliogone*, because 'tis in nothing *different* from what I should Represent to my self if I thought of a *Milion-angled figure*, or any other *Figure of More sides*; Neither does such a *Confused Representation* help me in the least to know those *Properties*, by which a *Chiliogone* differs from other *Polygones* or *Manyangled Figures*. But if a Question be put concerning a *Pentagone*, I know I may *Understand* its

Shape, as I *Understand* the *Shape*, of a *Chiliogone*, without the help of *Imagination*, but I can also *imagine* it, by applying the *Eye* of my *Mind* to its *Five sides*, and to the *Area* or *space* contained by Them; And herein I manifestly perceive that there is required a *peculiar sort* of *Operation* in the *Mind* to *imagine* a Thing, which I require not to *Understand* a Thing; which *New Operation* of the *Mind* plainly shews the *difference* between *imagination* and *pure Intellection*.

Besides this, I Consider that this *Power* of *Imagination* which is in me (as it differs from the *Power* of *Understanding*) does not appertain to the *Essence* of *Me*, that is, of my *mind*, for tho I *wanted* it, yet certainly I should be the *same He*, that now I *am*: from whence it seems to follow, that it depends on something *different* from my *self*; and I easily perceive that if any *Body* whatever did *Exist*, to which my *Mind* were so *conjoyn'd*, that it may Apply it self when it pleased to *Consider*, or (as it were) *Look* into this *Body*; From hence, I say, I perceive *It may so be*, that by this very *Body* I may *Imagine Corporeal Beings*: So that this *Manner* of *Thinking* differs from *pure Intellection* only in this, that the *Mind*, when it *Understands*, does as it were turn *it self*, to *it self*, or *Reflect* on it self, and *beholds* some or other of those *Ideas* which are in it self; But when it *Imagines*, it *Converts* it self upon *Body*, and therein *beholds* something Conformable to that *Idea*, which it hath *understood*, or *perceived* by *Sense*.

But 'tis to be remembred, that I said, I easily conceive *Imagination* *May be* so performed, supposing *Body* to *Exist*. And because no so convenient manner of *Explaining* it offers it self, from thence I *probably* guess, that *Body* does *Exist*. But this I only say *probably*, for tho I should accurately search into all the *Arguments* drawn from the *distinct Idea* of *Body*, which I find in my *Imagination*, yet I find none of them, from whence I may *necessarily* conclude, *that Body does Exist*.

But I have been accustomed to *Imagine* many other things besides that *Corporeal Nature* which is the *Object* of *pure Mathematicks*; such as are, *Colours*, *Sounds*, *Tasts*, *Pain*, &c. but none of these so *distinctly*. And because I perceive these better by *Sense*, from Which by the Help of the *Memory* they come to the *Imagination*, that I may with the Greater advantage treat of them, I ought at the same time to Consider *Sence*, and to try whether from what I perceive by that way of *Thought*, which I call

Sence, I can deduce any certain Argument for the *Existence* of *Corporeal Beings*.

And first I will here reflect with my self, what those things were, which being perceived by *Sence* I have heretofore thought *True*, and the *Reasons* why I *so thought*: I will then enquire into the *Reasons* for which I afterwards *doubted* those things. And last of all I will consider what I *ought* to *think* of those Things at *Present*.

First therefore I have always thought that I have had an *Head, Hands, Feet*, and other *Members*, of which *This Body* (which I have look'd upon as a *Part* of *Me*, or Perhaps as my *Whole self*) Consists; And I have also thought that this *Body* of *Mine* is Conversant or engaged among many *Other Bodies*, by which it is Liable to be *affected* with what is *advantagious* or *hurtful*; What was *Advantagious* I judged by a certain *sense* of *Pleasure*, what was *Hurtful* by a *sense* of *Pain*. Furthermore, besides *Pleasure* and *Pain*, I perceived in my self *Hunger, Thirst*, and other such like *Appetites*, as also certain *Corporeal Propensions* to *Mirth, Sadness, Anger*, and other like *Passions*.

The Reasons why I
Trusted my Senses.

As to What hapned to me from *Bodies without*, Besides the *Extension, Figure*, and *Motion* of those *Bodies*, I also perceived in them *Hardness, Heat*, and other *tactile Qualities*, as also *Light, Colours, Smells, Tasts, Sounds, &c.* and by the *Variation* of these I *distinguish'd* the *Heaven, Earth*, and *Seas*, and all other *Bodies* from each other.

Neither was it wholly without Reason (upon the account of these *Ideas* of *Qualities*, which offer'd themselves to my Thoughts, and which alone I *properly* and *Immediately perceived*) that I thought my self to Perceive some Things *Different* from my *Thought*, viz. The *Bodies* or *Objects* from whence these *Ideas* might *Proceed*; for I often found these *Ideas* come upon me without my *Consent* or *Will*; so that I can neither perceive an *Object* (*tho I had a mind to it*) unless it were *before* the Organs of my *Sense*; Neither can I *Hinder* my self from perceiving it, when it is *Present*.

And seeing that those *Ideas* which I take in by sense are much more *Lively, Apparent* and in their kind more *distinct*, than any of those which I *knowingly* and *Willingly* frame by Meditation, or stir up in my *Memory*; it seems to me that they cannot proceed from *my self*. There remains therefore no other way for them to come upon me, but from some other Things

Without Me. Of Which Things seeing *I* have no other Knowledge but from these *Ideas*, *I* cannot Think but that these *Ideas* are *like* the Things.

Moreover, Because *I* remember that *I* first made use of my *senses* before my *Reason*; and because *I* did perceive that those *Ideas* which *I* my self did frame were not so *Manifest* as those which *I* received by my *senses*, but very often *made up of their parts*, *I* was easily perswaded to think that *I* had no *Idea* in my *Understanding*, which *I* had not *First* in my *sense*.

Neither was it without Reason that *I* Judged, *That Body* (which by a *peculiar right* *I* call my *Own*) to be *more nighly* appertaining to *Me* than any *other Body*. For from *It*, as from other *Bodies*, *I* can never be *seperated*, *I* was *sensible* of all *Appetites* and *Affections in It* and *for It*, and lastly *I* perceived *pleasure* and *Pain* in its *Parts*, and not in any other Without it. But why from the *sense* of *Pain* a certain *Grief*, and from the *sense* of *pleasure* a certain *Joy* of the *Mind* should arise, or Why that *Gnawing* of the *stomach*, Which *I* call *Hunger*, should put me in mind of *Eating*, or the *driness* of my *Throat* of *Drinking*, *I* can give no other Reason but *that I am taught so by Nature*. For to my thinking there is no *Affinity* or *Likeness* between that *Gnawing* of the *Stomach*, and the desire of *Eating*, or between the *sense* of *Pain*, and the *sorrowful thought* from thence arising. But in this as in all other *judgments* that *I* made of *sensible objects*, *I* seem'd to be taught by *Nature*, for *I* first perswaded my self that things were so or so, before ever *I* enquired into a Reason that may prove it.

But afterwards *I* discover'd many experiments, wherein my *senses* so grosly deceived me, that *I* would never trust them again; for Towers which seem'd *Round* a far off, nigh at hand appear'd *square*, and *large* Statues on their tops seem'd *small* to those that stood on the ground; and in numberless other things, *I* perceived the *judgements* of my *outward senses* were *deceived*: and not of my *outward* only, but of my *inward senses* also; for what is more *intimate* or *inward* than *Pain*? And yet *I* have heard from those, whose Arm or Leg was cut off, that they have felt *pain* in that part which they *wanted*, and therefore *I* am not *absolutely certain* that any part of me is affected with *pain*, tho *I feel pain* therein. To these *I* have lately added two very *general Reasons* of *doubt*; The first was, that while *I* was *awake*, *I* could not believe my self to perceive any thing, which *I* could not think my self sometimes to perceive, tho *I* were *a sleep*; And seeing *I*

The Reasons why *I* doubted my senses.

Medit. I.

cannot believe, that what I seem to perceive in my *sleep* proceeds from *outward Objects*, what greater Reason have I to think so of what I perceive whilst I am *awake*? The other Cause of Doubt was, that seeing I know not the *Author* of my *Being* (or at least I then *supposed* my self not to know him) what reason is there but that I may be so ordered by *Nature* as to be *deceived* even in those things which appear'd to me most *true*. And as to the *Reasons*, which induced me to give *credit* to *sensible Things*, 'twas easie to return an answer thereto, for finding by experience, that I was impelled by *Nature* to many Things, which *Reason* dissuaded me from, I thought I should not far trust what I was taught by *Nature*. And tho the perceptions of my *senses* depended not on my *Will*, I thought I should not therefore conclude, that they proceeded from *Objects different* from my self; for perhaps there may be some other *Faculty* in me (tho as yet *unknown* to me) which might frame those *perceptions*.

But now that I begin better to know *my self* and the Author of my *Original*, I do not think, that all things, which I seem to have from my *senses* are *rashly* to be *admitted*, neither are all things so *had*, to be *doubted*. And first because I know that whatever I *clearly* and *distinctly* perceive, *may be* so made by *God* as I perceive them; the *Power* of *understanding clearly* and *distinctly* one Thing *without* the other is sufficient to make Me *certain* that One Thing is *different* from the Other; because it *may* at least be placed apart by *God*, and that it may be esteem'd *different*, it matters not by what *Power* it *may* be so *sever'd*. And therefore from the knowledge I have, that *I my self exist*, and because at the same time I understand that nothing else appertains to my *Nature* or *Essence*, but that I am a *thinking Being*, I rightly conclude, that my *Essence* consists in this alone, that I am a *thinking Thing*. And tho *perhaps* (or, as I shall shew presently, 'tis *certain*) I have a *Body* which is very *nighly* conjoyned to me, yet because on this side I have a clear and *distinct Idea* of my self, as I am only a *thinking Thing, not extended*; and on the other side because I have a *distinct Idea* of my *Body*, as it is onely an *extended thing, not thinking*, 'tis from hence *certain*, that I *am really distinct from my Body*, and that I can *exist without* it.

How far the senses
are now to be
trusted.

Moreover I find in my self some *Faculties* endow'd with *certain* peculiar waies of *thinking*, such as the *Faculty* of *Imagination*, the *Faculty* of *Perception* or *sense*; without which I can conceive my *whole self* clearly

and *distinctly*, but (changing the phrase) *I* cannot *conceive* those *Faculties* without *conceiving My self*, that is, an *understanding substance* in which they are; for none of them in their *formal Conception* includes *understanding*; from whence I perceive they are as *different* from *me*, as the *modus* or *manner* of a Thing is *different* from the *Thing it self*.

I acknowledge also, that I have several other *Faculties*, such as *changing of place, putting on various shapes, &c.* Which can no more be understood without a *substance* in which they are, then the foremention'd *Faculties*, and consequently they can no more be understood to *Exist* without that *substance*: But yet 'tis Manifest, that this sort of *Faculties*, to the End they may exist, ought to be in a *Corporeal, Extended*, and not in an *Understanding substance*, because *Extension*, and not *Intellection* or *Understanding* is included in the *Clear and Distinct conception* of them.

But there is also in me a certain *Passive Faculty* of *sense*, or of *Receiving* and *Knowing* the *Ideas* of *sensible Things*; of which *Faculty* I can make no use, unless there were in my self, or in something else, a certain *Active Faculty* of *Producing* and *Effecting* those *Ideas*. But this cannot be in my self, for it Pre-supposes no *Understanding*, and those *Ideas* are Produced in me, tho I help not, and often against my *Will*. There remains therefore no Place for this *Active Faculty*, but that it should be in some *substance different* from me. In which because all the *Reallity*, which is contain'd *Objectively* in the *Ideas* Produced by that *Faculty*, ought to be contain'd *Formally* or *Eminently* (as I have Formerly taken notice) this *substance* must be either a *Body* (in which what is in the *Ideas Objectively* is contain'd *Formally*) or it Must Be *God*, or some *Creature* more *excellent* than a *Body* (In which what is in the *Ideas Objectively* is contain'd *Eminently*). But seeing that *God* is not a *Deceivour*, 'tis altogether Manifest, that *he* does not Place these *Ideas* in me either *Immediately* from himself, or *Mediately* from any other *Creature*, wherein their *Objective Reallity* is not * contain'd *Formally*, but only *Eminently*. And seeing *God* has given me no *Faculty* to discern Whether these *Ideas* proceed from *Corporeal* or *Incorporeal Beings*, but rather a *strong Inclination* to believe that they are sent from *Corporeal Beings*, there is no Reason Why *God* should not be counted a *Deceiver*, if these *Ideas* came from any Where, but from *Corporeal Things*. Therefore we must conclude that there are *Corporeal Beings*. Which perhaps are not all the same as I comprehend them by *my*

sense (for Perception by sense is in many Things very *Obscure* and *Confused*) but those things at least, which I *clearly* and *distinctly* Understand, that is to say, all those things which are comprehended under the *Object* of *Pure Mathematicks*; those things I say at least are *True*.

As to What Remains, They are either some *Particulars*, as that the Sun is of such a *Bigness* or *Shape*, &c. or they are Things less *Clearly* Understood, as *Light*, *Sound*, *Pain*, &c. And tho these and such like Things may be very *Doubtful* and *Uncertain*, yet because *God* is not a *Deceiver*, and because that (Therefore) none of my Opinions can be *false* unless *God* has Given me some *Faculty* or other to *Correct* my *Error*, hence 'tis that I am encouraged with the Hopes of attaining *Truth* even in these very Things.

And certainly it cannot be doubted but whatever *I* am taught by *Nature* has something therein of *Truth*. By *Nature* in General I understand either *God* himself, or the *Coordination* of Creatures Made by *God*. By my *Own Nature* in *Particular* I understand the *Complexion* or *Association* of all those things which are given me by *God*.

Now there is nothing that this *my Nature* teaches me more *expresly* then that I have a *Body*, Which is not *Well* when I *feel Pain*, that this *Body* wants *Meat* or *Drink* When I am *Hungry* or *Dry*, &c. And therefore I ought not to Doubt but that these things are *True*. And by this *sense* of *Pain*, *Hunger*, *Thirst*, &c. My *Nature* tells me that *I* am not in my *Body*, as a *Mariner* is in his *Ship*, but that I am most *nighly conjoyn'd* thereto, and as it were *Blended therewith*; so that *I* with *It* make up *one* thing; For Otherwise, when the *Body* were hurt, *I*, who am only a *Thinking Thing*, should not therefore *feel Pain*, but should only *perceive* the Hurt with the *Eye* of my *Understanding* (as a *Mariner* *perceives* by his *sight* whatever is broken in his *Ship*) and when the *Body* wants either *Meat* or *Drink*, I should only *Understand* this want, but should not have the *Confused sense* of *Hunger* or *Thirst*; I call them *Confused*, for certainly the *Sense* of *Thirst*, *Hunger*, *Pain*, &c. are only *Confused Modes* or *Manners* of *Thought* arising from the *Union* and (as it were) *mixture* of the *Mind* and *Body*.

I am taught also by *Nature*, that there are many other *Bodies Without* and *About* my *Body*, some whereof are to be *desired*, others are to be *Avoided*. And because that I *Perceive* very Different *Colours*, *Sounds*, *Smells*, *Tasts*, *Heat*, *Hardness*, and the Like, from thence I *Rightly* conclude that there are

Correspondent Differences in Bodies, from which these *different perceptions* of sense proceed, tho perhaps not *Alike*. And because that some of these *perceptions* are *Pleasant*, others *Unpleasant*, 'tis evidently *certain*, that my *Body*, or rather my *Whole self* (as I am compounded of a *Mind* and *Body*) am liable to be *Affected* by these *Bodies* which encompass me about.

There are many Other Things Also which *Nature* seems to teach Me, but *Really* I am not taught by It, but have gotten them by an *ill use* of Passing my Judgement *Inconsiderately*, and from hence it is that these things happen often to be *false*; as that all *space* is *Empty*, in which I find *nothing* that works upon my *Senses*; That in a *hot Body* there is something like the *Idea* of *Heat* which is in me; That in a *White* or *Green Body* there is the same *Whiteness* or *Greenness* which I *perceive*; And the same *Taste* in a *bitter* or *sweet Thing*, &c. That *Stars*, *Castles*, and Other *Remote Bodies* are of the same *Bigness* and *Shape*, as they are *Represented* to my *senses*: and such like. But that I may not admit of any Thing in this very matter, which I cannot *Distinctly* perceive, it behoves me here to determine more *Accurately* What I mean when I say, *That I am taught a Thing by Nature*.

Here I take *Nature* more *strictly*, then for the *Complication* of all those Things which are Given me by *God*; For in this *Complication* there are many things contain'd which relate to the *Mind alone*, as, That I perceive What is *done* cannot be *not Done*, and all Other things which are known by the *Light* of *Nature*, but of these I speak not at present. There are also many Other Things which belong *only* to the *Body*, as, That it *tends Downwards* and such like, of these also I treat not at Present. But I speak of those Things only which *God* hath bestowed upon me as I am *Compounded* of a *Mind* and *Body together*, and not *differently Consider'd*. 'Tis *Nature* therefore thus taken that teaches me to *avoid troublesome Objects*, and *seek after pleasing Ones*; but it appears not that this *Nature* teaches us to conclude any thing of these *Perceptions* of our *senses*, before that we make by our *Understanding* a diligent examination of *outward Objects*; for to Enquire into the *Truth* of Things belongs not to the *Whole Compositum* of a Man as he Consists of *Mind* and *Body*, but to the *Mind alone*.

So that tho a *star* affect my eye no more then a *small spark* of *Fire*, yet there is in my Eye no *Real* or *Positive Inclination* to *believe* One no bigger then the Other, but thus I have been used to Judge from my Childhood without any Reason: and tho coming nigh the *Fire* I feel *Heat*, and Coming

too nigh I feel Pain, yet there is no Reason to perswade me, That in the Fire there is any thing *like* either that Heat or that Pain, but only that there is something therein, Whatever it be, that excites in us those *sensations* of Heat or Pain: and so tho in some space there may be nothing that Works on my *senses*, it does not from thence follow, that there is no *Body* there; for I see that in these and many other things I am used to overturn the Order of Nature, because I use these *perceptions* of *sense* (which properly are given me by Nature to make known to the mind what is *advantagious* or *hurtful* to the *Compositum*, whereof the *mind* is part, and so far only they are *Clear* and *Distinct* enough) as *certain Rules* immediately to discover the *Essence* of *External Bodies*, of Which they make known nothing but very *Obscurely* and *Confusedly*.

I have * formerly shewn how my *Judgement* happens to be false notwithstanding *Gods Goodness*. But now there arises a new *Difficulty* concerning those very things which *Nature* tells me I am to *prosecute* or *avoid*, concerning my *Internal senses*, Wherein I find many *Errors*, as when a Man being deceived by the Pleasant Taste of some sort of Meat, devours therein some hidden Poyson. But in this very Instance it cannot be said, that the Man is impelled by Nature to desire the *Poyson*, for of that he is wholly Ignorant; but he is said to Desire the *Meat* only as being of a grateful Taste; and from hence nothing can be concluded but, That *Mans-Nature* is not *All-knowing*; which is no Wonder seeing Man is a *Finite Being*, and therefore nothing but *Finite Perfections* belong to him.

Medit. 4.

But We often err even in those things to Which we are *Impelled* by *Nature*, as when sick men desire that *Meat* or *Drink*, which will certainly prove Hurtful to them. To this it may perhaps be reply'd, That they *Err* in this because their *Nature* is *Corrupt*. But this Answers not the Difficulty, For a sick man is no less *Gods Creature* then a Man in Health, and therefore 'tis as Absurd to Imagine a *Deceitful Nature* imposed by *God* on the One as on the Other; And as a Clock that is made up of Wheels and Weights does no less strictly observe the *Laws* of its *Nature*, when it is *ill* contrived, and tells the hours *falsly*, as when it answers the Desire of the Artificer in all performances; so if I consider the body of a Man as a meer *Machine* or *Movement*, made up and compounded of *Bones*, *Nerves*, *Muscles*, *Veins*, *Blood*, and *Skin*; so that, tho there were no *mind* in It, yet It would perform

all those Motions which now are in it (those only excepted which Proceed from the *Will*, and consequently from the *Mind*) I do easily acknowledge, that it would be as *natural* for him (if for example sake he were sick of a *Dropsie*) to suffer that *Driness* of his *Throat* which uses to bring into his mind the *sense* of *Thirst*, & that thereby his Nerves and other Parts would be so disposed as to take Drink, by Which his disease would be encreased; As (supposing him to be troubled with no such Distemper) by the like Driness of Throat he would be disposed to Drink, when 'tis Requisite. And tho, if I respect the Intended use of a Clock I may say that it *Errs* from its *Nature*, when it tells the Hours *wrong*, and so considering the *Movement* of a *Mans Body* as contrived for such *Motions* as are used to be performed thereby, I may think That also to *Err* from its *Nature*, if its *Throat* is *Dry*, when it has no want of Drink for its *Preservation*. Yet I Plainly discover, that this last *Acceptation* of *Nature* differs much from that whereof we have been speaking all this While, for this is only a *Denomination extrinsick* to the Things whereof 'tis spoken, and *depending* on my *Thought*, while it *Compares* a *sick* man, and a *disorderly* Clock with the *Idea* of an *healthy* man and a *Rectified* Clock. But by *Nature* in its former *Acceptation* I Understand something that is *Really* in the *Things* themselves, which therefore has something of *Truth* in it.

But tho Respecting only a *Body* sick of a Dropsie it be an *Extrinsick Denomination* to say, that its *Nature* is *Corrupt*, because it has a *Dry Throat*, and stands in *no need* of Drink; yet respecting the *Whole Compound* or *Mind* joyn'd to such a *Body*, 'tis not a *meer Denomination*, but a *real Error* of *Nature* for it to *thirst* when *drink* is *hurtful* to it. It remains therefore here to be inquired, how the *Goodness* of *God* suffers *Nature* so taken to be *deceivable*.

First therefore I understand that a *chief difference* between my *Mind* and *Body* consists in this, That my *Body* is of its *Nature divisible*, but my *Mind indivisible*; for while I consider my *Mind* or my *self*, as I am only a *thinking Thing*, I can distinguish *no parts* in Me, but I perceive my self to be but *one entire* Thing; and tho the *whole Mind* seems to be *united* to the *whole Body*, yet a Foot, an Arm, or any other part of the Body being cut off, I do not therefore conceive any *part* of my *Mind* taken away; Neither can its *Faculties* of *desiring*, *perceiving*, *understanding*, &c. be called its *Parts*, for 'tis one and the *same*, *mind*, that *desires*, that *perceives*, that *understands*;

Contrarily, I cannot think of any *Corporeal* or *extended Being*, which I cannot easily *divide* into *Parts* by my thought, and by this I understand it to be *divisible*. And this alone (if I had known it from no other Argument) is sufficient to inform me, that my *mind* is *really distinct* from my *Body*.

Nextly I find, that my *mind* is not *immediately affected* by all parts of my *body*, but only by the *Brain*, and perhaps only by one small part of it, That, to wit, wherein the *common sense* is said to reside; Which part, as often as it is disposed in the *same manner*, will represent to the *mind* the *same thing*, tho at the same time the other parts of the *body* may be *differently order'd*. And this is proved by numberless Experiments, which need not here be related.

Moreover I discover that the *nature* of my *body* is such, that no part of it can be *moved* by an other *remote* part thereof, but it may also be *moved* in the *same manner* by some of the *interjacent* parts, tho the more *remote* part lay still and acted not; As for example in the Rope,

A B C D

if its end D. were drawn, the end A. would be moved no otherwise, than if one of the intermediate parts B. or C. were drawn, and the end D. rest quiet. So when I feel *pain* in my *Foot*, the consideration of Physicks instructs me, that this is performed by the help of *Nerves* dispersed through the *Foot*, which from thence being *continued* like Ropes to the very *Brain*, whilst they are *drawn* in the *Foot*, they also *draw* the inward parts of the *Brain* to which they reach, and therein excite a certain *motion*, which is ordain'd by *Nature* to affect the *mind* with a *sense* of *Pain*, as being in the *Foot*. But because these *Nerves* must pass through the *Shin*, the *Thighs*, the *Loins*, the *Back*, the *Neck*, before they can reach the *Brain* from the *Foot*, it may so happen, that tho *that part* of them, which is in the *Foot* were not touch'd, but only some of their *intermediate parts*, yet the same *motion*, would be caused in the *Brain*, as when the *Foot* it self is *ill affected*, from whence 'twill necessarily follow, that the *mind* should *perceive* the same *Pain*. And thus may we think of any other *Sense*.

I understand lastly, that seeing each single motion perform'd in that part of the *Brain*, which *immediately affects* the *mind*, excites therein only one sort of *sense*, nothing could be contrived more conveniently in this case, than that, of all those *Senses* which it can cause, it should cause that which

chiefly, and most *frequently* conduces to the *conservation* of an *healthful Man*; And experience witnesses, that to this very *end* all our *senses* are given us by *Nature*; and therefore nothing can be found therein, which does not abundantly testify the *Power* and *Goodness* of *God*. Thus for Example, when the Nerves of the Feet are violently and more than ordinarily moved, that motion of them being propagated through the *Medulla Spinalis* of the Back to the inward parts of the Brain, there it signifies to the mind, that something or other is to be felt, and what is this but Pain, as if it were in the Foot, by which the Mind is excited to use its indeavours for removing the Cause, as being hurtful to the Foot. But the *Nature* of *Man* might have been so *order'd* by *God*, that That same motion in the Brain should represent to the mind any other thing, *viz.* either it self as 'tis in the Brain, or it self as it is in the Foot, or in any of the other forementioned intermediate parts, or lastly any other thing whatsoever; but none of these would have so much conduced to the *Conservation* of the *Body*. In the like manner when we want drink, from thence arises a certain *dryness* in the *Throat*, which moves the Nerves thereof, and by their means the inward parts of the Brain, and this motion *affects* the *mind* with the *sense* of *thirst*; because that in this case nothing is more requisite for us to know, then that we *want drink* for the *Preservation* of our *Health*. So of the Rest.

From all which 'tis manifest, that (notwithstanding the *infinite Goodness* of *God*) 'tis impossible but the *Nature* of *Man* as he consists of a *mind* and *body* should be *deceivable*. For if any cause should excite (not in the Foot but) in the Brain it self, or in any other part through which the Nerves are continued from the Foot to the Brain, that *self same* motion, which uses to arise from the Foot being troubled, the *Pain* would be felt *as in the Foot*, and the *sense* would be *naturally* deceived; for 'tis consonant to Reason (seeing that That same motion of the Brain alwayes represents to the mind that same sense, and it oftner proceeds from a cause *hurtful* to the *Foot*, than from any other) I say 'tis reasonable, that it should make known to the *mind* the Pain of the *Foot*, rather than of any other *part*. And so if a *dryness* of *Throat* arises (not as 'tis used from the *necessity* of *drink* for the *conservation* of the *Body*, but) from an *unusual Cause*, as it happens in a *Dropsie*, 'tis far better that it should *then deceive us*; then that it should *always deceive us* when the *Body* is in *Health*, and so of the Rest.

And this consideration helps me very much, not only to *understand* the *Errors* to which my *Nature* is subject, but also to *correct* and *avoid* them. For seeing I know that all my *Senses* do oftener inform me *falsly* than *truely* in those things which conduce to the *Bodies advantage*; and seeing I can use (almost alwayes) more of them than one to *Examine* the same thing, as also I can use *memory*, which joyns present and past things together, and my *understanding* also, which hath already discovered to me all the *causes* of my *Errors*, I ought no longer to fear, that what my *Senses* daily represent to me should be false. But especially those *extravagant Doubts* of my First Meditation are to be turn'd off as ridiculous; and perticularly the *chief* of them, viz. That * of not *distinguishing Sleep* from *Waking*, for now I plainly discover a great *difference*, between them, for my *Dreams* are never *conjoynd* by my *memory* with the other *actions* of my *life*, as whatever happens to me *awake* is; and certainly if (while I were awake) any person should suddenly appear to me, and presently disappear (as in *Dreams*) so that I could not tell *from whence* he came or *where* he went, I should rather esteem it a *Spectre* or *Apparition feign'd* in my Brain, then a *true Man*; but when such things occur, as I distinctly know from *whence*, *where*, and *when* they come, and I *conjoyn* the *perception* of them by my *memory* with the other *Accidents* of my *life*, I am *certain* they are represented to me *waking* and not *asleep*, neither ought I in the least to doubt of their *Truth*, if after I have called up all my *senses*, *memory*, and *understanding* to their *Examination* I find nothing in any of them, that clashes with other truths; For *God* not being a *Deceiver*, it follows, that In such things I am not *deceived*. But because the *urgency* of *Action* in the common *occurrences* of *Affairs* will not alwayes allow time for such an *accurate examination*, I must confess that *Mans life* is *subject* to many *Errors* about *perticulars*, so that the *infirmity* of our *Nature* must be *acknowledged* by Us.

FINIS.

ADVERTISEMENT CONCERNING THE OBJECTIONS.

Among seven Parcels of Objections made by Divers Learned Persons against these Meditations, I have made choise of the Third in the Latine Copy, as being Penn'd by *Thomas Hobbs* of *Malmesbury*, a Man famously known to the World abroad, but especially to his own the English Nation; and therefore 'tis likely that what comes from Him may be more acceptable to his Countrymen, then what proceeds from a Stranger; and as the strength of a Fortification is never better known then by a Forcible Resistance, so fares it with these *Meditations* which stand unshaken by the Violent Opposition of so Potent an Enemy. And yet it must be Confess'd that the Force of these Objections and Cogency of the Arguments cannot be well apprehended by those who are not versed in other Pieces of Mr. *Hobbs's* Philosophy, especially His Book *De Corpore* and *De Homine*, The former whereof I am sure is Translated into English, and therefore not Impertinently refer'd to Here in a Discourse to English Readers. And this is the Reason that makes the Great *Des-Cartes* pass over many of these Objections so slightly, Who certainly would have Undermined the whole Fabrick of the *Hobbian Philosophy* had he but known upon What Foundations it was Built.

OBJECTIONS
Made against the Foregoing
MEDITATIONS,
BY THE FAMOUS
THOMAS HOBBS
Of MALMESBURY,
WITH
DES-CARTES'S
ANSWERS.

OBJECT. I.

Against the First Meditation: Of things Doubtful.

'Tis evident enough from What has been said in this Meditation, that there is no *sign* by Which we may Distinguish our *Dreams* from *True Sense* and *Waking*, and therefore that those *Phantasmes* which we have waking and from our Senses are not accidents inhering in Outward Objects, neither do they Prove that such outward Objects do Exist; and therefore if we trust our Senses without any other Ground, we may well doubt whether any Thing *Be* or *Not*. We therefore acknowledge the Truth of this Meditation. But Because *Plato* and other Antient Philosophers argued for the same *incertainty* in sensible Things, and because 'tis commonly Observed by the Vulgar that 'tis hard to Distinguish Sleep from Waking, I would not have the most excellent Author of such new Thoughts put forth so antique Notions.

ANSWER.

Those Reasons of Doubt which by this Philosopher are admitted as *true*, were proposed by Me only as *Probable*, and I made use of them not that I may vend them as *new*, but partly that I may prepare the Minds of my Readers for the Consideration of Intellectual Things, wherein they seem'd to me very necessary; And partly that thereby I may shew how firm those Truths are, which hereafter I lay down, seeing they cannot be Weaken'd by these Metaphysical Doubts: So, that I never designed to gain any Honor by repeating them, but I think I could no more omit them, then a Writer in Physick can pass over the Description of a Disease, Whose Cure he intends to Teach.

OBJECT. II.

Against the Second Meditation: Of the Nature of Mans Mind.

I am a *Thinking Thing*. 'Tis True; for because I *think* or have a *Phantasme* (whether I am *awake* or *asleep*) it follows that *I am Thinking*, for *I Think* and *I am Thinking* signifie the same Thing. Because *I Think*, it follows That *I am*, for whatever *Thinks* cannot be *Nothing*. But when he Adds, *That is, a Mind, a Soul, an Understanding, Reason*, I question his Argumentation; for it does not seem a Right Consequence to say, *I am a Thinking Thing*, therefore *I am a Thought*, neither, *I am an Understanding Thing*, therefore *I am the Understanding*. For in the same manner I may Conclude, *I am a Walking Thing*, therefore *I am the Walking it self*.

Wherefore *D.Cartes* Concludes that an *Understanding Thing* and *Intellection* (which is the Act of an Understanding Thing) are the same; or at least that an *Understanding Thing* and the *Intellect* (which is the Power of an Understanding Thing) are the same; And yet all Philosophers distinguish the *subject* from its *Faculties* and *Acts*, that is, from its *Properties* and *Essence*, for the *Thing it self* is one thing, and its *Essence* is an other. It may be therefore that a *Thinking Thing* is the *Subject* of a *Mind, Reason, or Understanding*, and therefor it may be a *Corporeal Thing*, the Contrary Whereof is here *Assumed* and not *Proved*; and yet this *Inference* is the *Foundation* of that Conclusion which *D.Cartes* would Establish.

In the same Meditation, on, * *I know that I am, I ask, What I am Whom I Thus Know, Certainly the Knowledge of Me precisely so taken depends not on those Things of whose Existence I am yet Ignorant.*

* Places noted with this Asterick are the Passages of the foregoing Meditations here Objected against.

'Tis Certain the Knowledge of this Proposition *I am*, depends on this, *I think* as he hath rightly inform'd us; but from whence have we the knowledge of this Proposition, *I think*? certainly from hence only, that we cannot conceive any *Act* without its *subject*, as *dancing* without a *Dancer*, *knowledge*, without a *Knower*, *thought* without a *thinker*.

And from hence it seems to follow, that a *thinking Thing* is a *Corporeal Thing*; for the *Subjects* of all *Acts* are understood only in a *Corporeal* way, or after the manner of *matter*, as he himself shews hereafter by the example

of a piece of Wax, which changing its *colour, consistence, shape*, and other Acts is yet known to continue the *same thing*, that is, the *same matter* subject to so many *changes*. But I cannot conclude from another *thought* that *I now think*; for tho a Man may *think* that he *hath thought* (which consists only in *memory*) yet 'tis altogether impossible for him to *think* that he *now thinks*, or to *know*, that *he knows*, for the question may be put *infinitely*, how do you *know* that you *know*, that you *know*, that you *know*? &c.

Wherefore seeing the Knowledge of this Proposition *I am*, depends on the knowledge of this *I think*, and the knowledge of this is from hence only, that we cannot separate *thought* from *thinking matter*, it seems rather to follow, that a *thinking thing* is *material*, than that 'tis *immaterial*.

ANSWER.

When I said, *That is a Mind, a Soul, an Understanding, Reason, &c.* I did not mean by these *names* the *Faculties* only, but the *things* indow'd with those *Faculties*; and so 'tis alwayes understood by the two first names (*mind* and *soul*) and very often so understood by the two last Names (*understanding* and *Reason*) and this I have explain'd so often, and in so many places of these Meditations, that there is not the least occasion of questioning my meaning.

Neither is there any parity between *Walking* and *Thought*, for *walking* is used only for the *Act* it self, but *thought* is sometimes used for the *Act*, sometimes for the *Faculty*, and sometimes for the *thing* it self, wherein the *Faculty* resides.

Neither do I say, that the *understanding thing* and *intellection* are the same, or that the *understanding thing* and the *intellect* are the same, if the *intellect* be taken for the *Faculty*, but only when 'tis taken for the *thing it self that understands*. Yet I willingly confess, that I have (as much as in me lay) made use of *abstracted words* to signifie that *thing* or *substance*, which I would have devested of all those things that belong not to it. Whereas contrarily this Philosopher uses the most *concrete Words* to signifie this *thinking thing*, such as *subject, matter, Body, &c.* that he may not suffer it to be separated from *Body*.

Neither am I concern'd that His manner of joyning many things together may seem to some fitter for the discovery of Truth, than mine, wherein I separate as much as possibly each particular. But let us omit words and speak of things.

It may be (sayes he) that a Thinking thing is a corporeal thing, the contrary whereof is here assumed and not proved. But herein he is mistaken, for I never assumed the contrary, neither have I used it as a *Foundation*, for the rest of my *Superstructure*, but left it wholly undetermin'd till the sixth Meditation, and in that 'tis proved.

Then he tells us rightly, *that we cannot conceive any Act without its subject, as thought without a thinking thing*, for what *thinks* cannot be *nothing*; but then he subjoyns without any Reason, and against the usual manner of speaking, and contrary to all Logick, *that hence it seem to follow, that a thinking thing is a corporeal Being.* Truly the subjects of all Acts are understood under the notion of *substance*, or if you please under the notion of *matter* (that is to say of *metaphysical matter*) but not therefore under the notion of *Bodies*.

But Logicians and Commonly all Men are used to say, that there are some *Spiritual*, some *Corporeal* substances. And by the Instance of Wax I only proved that *Colour, Consistence, Shape, &c.* appertain not to the *Ratio Formalis* of the Wax; For in that Place I treated neither of the *Ratio Formalis* of the Mind, neither of *Body*.

Neither is it pertinent to the business, that the Philosopher asserts, *That one Thought cannot be the subject of an other thought*, for Who besides Himself ever Imagin'd This? But that I may explain the matter in a few words, 'Tis certain that *Thought* cannot be without a *Thinking Thing*, neither any *Act* or any *Accident* without a *substance* wherein it resides. But seeing that we know not a *substance immediately by it self*, but by this alone, that 'tis the *subject* of several Acts, it is very consonant to the commands of Reason and Custome, that we should call by *different names* those *substances*, which we perceive are the *subjects* of very *different Acts* or *Accidents*, and that afterwards we should examine, whether those *different names* signifie *different* or *one* and the *same* thing. Now there are some Acts which we call *corporeal*, as *magnitude, figure, motion*, and what ever else cannot be thought on without *local extension*, and the *substance*

wherein these reside we call *Body*; neither can it be imagin'd that 'tis one *substance* which is the *subject* of *Figure*, and another *substance* which is the *subject* of *local motion*, &c. Because all these *Acts* agree under one common notion of *Extension*. Besides there are other *Acts*, which we call *cogitative* or *thinking*, as *understanding*, *will*, *imagination*, *sense*, &c. All which agree under the common notion of *thought*, *perception*, or *Conscience*; And the *substance* wherein they are, we say, is a *thinking thing*, or *mind*, or call it by whatever other name we please, so we do not confound it with *corporeal substance*, because *cogitative Acts* have no affinity with *corporeal Acts*, and *thought*, which is the common *Ratio* of *those* is wholly different from *Extension*, which is the common *Ratio* of *These*. But after we have formed two *distinct conceptions* of these two *substances*, from what is said in the sixth Meditation, 'tis easie to know, whether they be *one* and the *same* or *different*.

OBJECT. III.

* *Which of them is it, that is distinct from my thought? which of them is it that can be separated from me?*

Some perhaps will answer this Question thus, I my self, who *think* am distinct from my *thought*, and my *thought* is *different* from me (tho' not *seperated*) as *dancing* is *distinguished* from the *Dancer* (as before is noted.) But if *Des-Cartes* will prove, that *he* who *understands* is the same with his *understanding*, we shall fall into the Scholastick expressions, the *understanding understands*, the *sight sees*, the *Will wills*, and then by an exact analogy, the *Walking* (or at least the *Faculty* of walking) shall walk. All which are obscure, improper, and unworthy that perspicuity which is usual with the noble *Des-Cartes*.

ANSWER.

I do not deny, that *I* who *think* am *distinct* from my *thought*, as a *thing* is *distinguish'd* from its *modus* or *manner*; But when I ask, *which of them is it that is distinct from my thought?* this I understand of those various *modes* of *thought* there mention'd, and not of *substance*; and when I subjoyn, *which of them is it that can be separated from me?* I only signifie that all those *modes* or *manners* of *thinking* reside in me, neither do I herein perceive what occasion of *doubt* or *obscurity* can be imagined.

OBJECT. IV.

** It remains therefore for me to Confess that I cannot Imagine what this Wax is, but that I conceive in my mind What it is.*

There is a great Difference between *Imagination* (that is) having an *Idea* of a Thing, and the *Conception of the Mind* (that is) a *Concluding* from *Reasoning* that a thing *Is* or *Exists*. But *Des-Cartes* has not Declared to us in what they Differ. Besides, the Ancient Aristotelians have clearly deliver'd as a Doctrine, that *substance* is not *perceived* by *sense* but is *Collected* by *Ratiocination*.

But what shall we now say, if perhaps *Ratiocination* be nothing Else but a *Copulation* or *Concatenation* of *Names* or *Appellations* by this Word *Is*? From whence 'twill follow that we *Collect* by *Reasoning* nothing *of* or *concerning* the *Nature* of *Things*, but of the *names* of *Things*, that is to say, we only discover whether or no we *joyn* the *Names* of *Things* according to the *Agreements* which at *Pleasure* we have made concerning their *significations*; if it be so (as so it may be) *Ratiocination* will depend on *Words*, *Words* on *Imagination*, and perhaps *Imagination* as *also* *Sense* on the *Motion* of *Corporeal Parts*; and so the *Mind* shall be nothing but *Motions* in some *Parts* of an *Organical Body*.

ANSWER.

I have here Explain'd the Difference between *Imagination*, and the Meer *Conception* of the *Mind*, by reckoning up in my Example of the Wax, what it is therein which we *Imagine*, and what it is that we *conceive* in our *Mind* only: but besides this, I have explained in an other Place How we *understand* one way, and *Imagine* an other way One and the same Thing, suppose a *Pentagone* or *Five sided Figure*.

There is in *Ratiocination* a *Conjunction* not of *Words*, but of *Things signified* by *Words*; And I much admire that the *Contrary* could Possibly enter any Mans Thoughts; For Who ever doubted but that a *Frenchman* and a *German* may argue about the *same Things*, tho they use very *Differing Words*? and does not the *Philosopher* Disprove himself when he speaks of

the *Agreements which at pleasure we have made about the significations of Words?* for if he grants that *something* is *Signified* by *Words*, Why will he not admit that our Ratiocinations are rather about this *something*, then about *Words* only? and by the same Right that he concludes the *Mind* to be a *Motion*, he may Conclude Also that the Earth is Heaven, or What else he Pleases.

OBJECT. V.

Against the Third Meditation of God.

* *Some of These (viz. Humane Thoughts) are as it were the Images of Things, and to these alone belongs properly the Name of an Idea, as when I Think on a Man, a Chimera, Heaven, an Angel, or God.*

When I Think on a *Man* I perceive an *Idea* made up of *Figure* and *Colour*, whereof I may *doubt* whether it be the *Likeness* of a *Man* or not; and so when I think on *Heaven*. But when I think on a *Chimera*, I perceive an *Image* or *Idea*, of which I may *doubt* whether it be the *Likeness* of any *Animal* not only at present Existing, but possible to Exist, or that ever will Exist hereafter or not.

But thinking on an *Angel*, there is offer'd to my Mind sometimes the *Image* of a *Flame*, sometimes the *Image* of a *Pretty Little Boy* with *Wings*, which I am certain has no *Likeness* to an *Angel*, and therefore that it is not the *Idea* of an *Angel*; But beleiving that there are some Creatures, Who do (as it were) wait upon God, and are Invisible, and Immaterial, upon the *Thing Believed* or *supposed* we Impose the *Name* of *Angel*; Whereas the *Idea*, under which I Imagine an *Angel*, is compounded of the *Ideas* of sensible Things.

In the like manner at the Venerable Name of *God*, we have *no Image* or *Idea* of *God*, and therefore we are forbidden to *Worship God* under any *Image*, least we should seem to *Conceive* Him that is inconceivable.

Whereby it appears that we have no *Idea* of *God*; but like one *born blind*, who being brought to the *Fire*, and perceiving himself to be *Warmed*, knows there is *something* by which he is *warmed* and Hearing it called *Fire*, he Concludes that *Fire Exists*, but yet knows not of what *shape* or *Colour* the *Fire* is, neither has he any *Image* or *Idea* thereof in his *Mind*.

So Man knowing that there must be some *Cause* of his *Imaginations* or *Ideas*, as also an other *cause before That*, and so *onwards*, he is brought at last to an *End*, or to a *supposal* of some *Eternal Cause*, Which because it never *began* to *Be* cannot have any other *Cause before it*, and thence he Concludes that 'tis *necessary* that some *Eternal Thing* Exist: and yet he has

no *Idea* which He can call the *Idea* of this *Eternal Thing*, but he names this *Thing*, which he believes and acknowledges by the Name *God*.

But now *Des-Cartes* proceeds from this Position, *That we have an Idea of God in our Mind*, to prove this Theoreme, *That God (that if an Almighty, Wise, Creatour of the World) Exists*, whereas he ought to have explain'd this *Idea* of *God* better, and he should have thence deduced not only his *Existence*, but also the *Creation* of the World.

ANSWER.

Here the Philosopher will have the Word *Idea* be only Understood for the *Images* of *Material* Things represented in a *Corporeal* Phantasie, by which Position he may Easily Prove, that there can be no Proper *Idea* of an *Angel* or *God*. Whereas as I declare every Where, but especially in this Place, that I take the Name *Idea* for whatever is immediately *perceived* by the *Mind*, so that when I *Will*, or *Fear*, because at the same time I *perceive* that I *Will* or *Fear*, this very *Will* or *Fear* are reckon'd by me among the number of *Ideas*; And I have purposely made use of that Word, because It was usual with the Antient Philosophers to signifie the Manner of *Perceptions* in the *Divine Mind*, altho neither we nor they acknowledge a Phantasie in *God*: and besides I had no fitter Word to express it by.

And I think I have sufficiently explain'd the *Idea* of *God* for those that will attend my meaning, but I can never do it fully enough for those that will Understand my Words otherwise then I intend them.

Lastly, what is here added concerning the *Creation* of the World is wholly beside the Question in hand.

OBJECT. VI.

** But there are Other (Thoughts) That have Superadded Forms to them, as when I Will, when I Fear, when I Affirm, when I Deny; I know I have alwayes (whenever I think) some certain thing as the Subject or Object of my Thought, but in this last sort of Thoughts there is something More which I think upon then Barely the Likeness of the Thing; and of these Thoughts some are called Wills and Affections, and others of them Judgements.*

When any one *Fears* or *Wills*, he has certainly the *Image* of the *Thing Fear'd*, or *Action Will'd*, but what more a *Willing* or *Fearing* Man has in his Thoughts is not explain'd; and tho *Fear* be a *Thought*, yet I see not how it can be any other then the *Thought* of the *Thing Fear'd*; For what is the *Fear* of a *Lion rushing on me*, but the *Idea* of a *Lion Rushing on me*, and the *Effect* (which that *Idea* produces in the *Heart*) whereby the Man *Fearing* is excited to that Animal Motion which is called *Flight*? but now this Motion of *Flying* is not *Thought*, it remains therefore that in *Fear* there is no other *Thought*, but that which consists in the *likeness* of the thing. And the same may be said of *Will*.

Moreover *Affirmation* and *Negation* are not without a *voice* and *words*, and hence 'tis that Brutes can neither *affirme* or *deny* not so much as in their *Thought*, and consequently neither can they judge. But yet the same thought may be in a beast as in a Man; for when we *affirme* that a Man runs, we have not a *thought* different from what a Dog has when he sees his Master running; *Affirmation* therefore or *Negation* superadds nothing to *meer thoughts*, unless perhaps it adds this thought, that the *names* of which an *Affirmation* consists are (to the Person *affirming*) the *Names* of the *same thing*; and this is not to comprehend in the *thought* more then the *likeness* of the *thing*, but it is only comprehending the same *likeness* twice.

ANSWER.

'Tis self evident, That 'tis one thing to *see* a *Lion* and at the same time to *fear* him, and an other thing *only* to *see* him. So 'tis one thing to *see* a *Man Running*, and an other thing to *Affirme* within my self (which may be done without a voice) That I *see* him.

But in all this objection I find nothing that requires an Answer.

OBJECT. VII.

* Now it remains for me to examine, how I have received this *Idea* of God, for I have neither received it by means of my senses, neither comes it to me without my forethought, as the *Ideas* of sensible things use to do, when those things work on the *Organs* of my sense, or at least seem so to work; Neither is this *Idea* framed by my self, for I can neither add to, nor detract from it. Wherefore I have only to conclude, that it is innate, even as the *Idea* of me my self is Natural to my self.

If there be no *Idea* of God, as it seems there is not (and here 'tis not proved that there is) this whole discourse falls to the ground. And as to the *Idea* of my self (if I respect the *Body*) it proceeds from *Sight*, but (if the *Soul*) there is no *Idea* of a *Soul*, but we collect by *Ratiocination*, that there is some inward thing in a Mans *Body*, that imparts to it *Animal Motion*, by which it *perceives* and *moves*, and this (whatever it be) without any *Idea* we call a *Soul*.

ANSWER.

If there be an *Idea* of God (as 'tis manifest that there is) this whole *Objection* falls to the ground; and then he subjoyns, *That we have no Idea of the Soul, but collect it by Ratiocination*, 'Tis the same as if he should say, that there is no *Image* thereof represented in the *Phantasie*, but yet, that there is such a Thing, as I call an *Idea*.

OBJECT. VIII.

* *An other Idea of the Sun as taken from the Arguments of Astronomers, that is consequentially collected by me from certain natural notions.*

At the same time we can certainly have but one *Idea* of the Sun, whether it be look'd at by our eyes, or collected by *Ratiocination* to be much bigger than it seems; for this last is not an *Idea* of the Sun, but a proof by Arguments, that the *Idea* of the Sun would be much larger, if it were look'd at nigher. But at different or several times the *Ideas* of the Sun may be diverse, as if at one time we look at it with our bare eye, at an other time through a Teloscope; but Astronomical arguments do not make the *Idea* of the Sun greater or less, but they rather tell us that the *sensible Idea* thereof is *false*.

ANSWER.

Here also (as before) what he says is not the *Idea* of the Sun, and yet is described, is that very thing which I call the *Idea*.

OBJECT. IX.

* For without doubt those Ideas which Represent substances are something more, or (as I may say) have more of objective Reality in them, then those that represent only accidents or modes; and again, that by which I understand a mighty God, Eternal, Infinite, Omniscient, Omnipotent, Creatour of all things besides himself, has certainly in it more objective reality, then those by which Finite substances are exhibited.

I have before often noted that there can be no *Idea* of God or the *Mind*: I will now superadd, That neither can there be an *Idea* of *Substance*. For *Substance* (Which is only *Matter Subject* to *Accidents* and *Changes*) is *Collected* only by *Reasoning*, but it is not at all *Conceived*, neither does it represent to us any *Idea*. And if this be true, How can it be said, *That those Ideas which represent to us Substances have in them something More, or More Objective Reality, then those which represent to us Accidents?* Besides, Let *Des-Cartes* again Consider what he means by *More Reality?* Can *Reality* be increas'd or diminish'd? Or does he think that *One Thing* can be *More A Thing* then an other *Thing*? let him Consider how this can be Explain'd to our Understandings with that *Perspicuity* or *Clearness* which is requisite in all *Demonstrations*, and Which He Himself is used to present us with upon other Occasions.

ANSWER.

I have often noted before, That that very Thing which is *evidenc'd* by *Reason*, as also whatever else is perceived by any other Means, is Called by Me an *Idea*. And I have sufficiently explain'd How *Reality* may be *Encreas'd* or *Diminish'd*, in the same manner (to wit) as *Substance* is *More a Thing*, then *A Mode*; and if there be any such things as *Real Qualities*, or *Incomplete Substances*, these are *More Things* then *Modes*, and *Less Things* then *Complete Substances*: and Lastly if there be an *Infinite Independent Substance* this is *More a Thing*, then a *Finite, Dependent Substance*. And all this is self-evident.

OBJECT. X.

* *Wherefore There only Remains the Idea of God; Wherein I must consider whether there be not something Included, which cannot Possibly have its Original from me. By the Word, God, I mean a certain Infinite Substance, Independent, Omniscient, Almighty, by whom both I my self and every thing Else That Is (if any thing do actually exist) was Created; All which attributes are of such an High Nature That the more attentively I consider them, the Less I Conceive my self alone possible to be the Author of these notions; from what therefore has been said I must Conclude there is a God.*

Considering the *Attributes* of *God*, that from thence we may gather an *Idea* of *God*, and that we may enquire whether there be not something in that *Idea* which cannot Possibly Proceed from our selves, I discover (if I am not Deceived) that what we think off at the *Venerable name* of *God* proceeds neither from our selves, neither is it Necessary that they should have any other *Original* then from *Outward Objects*. For by the Name of *God* I understand a Substance, that is, I understand that *God* Exists (not by an *Idea*, but by Reasoning) Infinite (that is, I cannot conceive or Imagine Terms or Parts in him so Extream, but I can Imagine others Farther) from whence it follows, that not an *Idea* of *Gods Infinity* but of my Own bounds and Limits presents it self at the Word *Infinite*. Independent, That is, I do not conceive any *Cause* from which *God* may proceed; from whence 'tis evident that I have no other *Idea* at the word *Independent*, but the memory of my own *Ideas* which at Different Times have *Different Beginnings*, and Consequently they must be *Dependent*.

Wherefore, to say that *God* is *Independent*, is only to say That *God* is in the Number of those things, the *Original* whereof I do not Imagine: and so to say that *God* is *Infinite*, is the same as if we say That He is in the Number of Those Things whose *Bounds* we do not Conceive: And thus any *Idea* of *God* is Exploded, for What *Idea* can we have without *Beginning* or *Ending*?

Omniscient or Understanding all things, Here I desire to know, by what *Idea*, *Des-Cartes* understands *Gods Understanding*? Almighty, I desire also to know by What *Idea* *Gods Power* is understood? For *Power* is in Respect of Future Things, that is, Things not Existing. For my Part, I understand

Power from the Image or Memory of past Actions, arguing with my self thus, He did so, therefore he was *able* (or had *Power*) to do so, therefore (continuing the same) he will again have *Power* to do so. But now all these are *Ideas* that may arise from *external Objects*.

Creatour of all things, *I* can frame an *Image* of *Creation* from what I see every day, as a Man Born, or growing from a Punctum to that shape and size he now bears; an other *Idea* then this no man can have at the word *Creatour*; But the *Possibility* of *Imagining* a *Creation* is not sufficient to prove that the world was *created*. And therefore tho it were *Demonstrated* that some *Infinite Independent Almighty Being* did *exist*, yet it will not from thence follow that a *Creatour* exists; unless one can think this to be a right inference, we *believe* that there exists something that has created all other things, therefore the world was *Created* thereby.

Moreover when he says, that the *Idea* of *God*, and of our *Soul* is *Innate* or *born in us*, I would fain know, whether the *Souls* of those that *sleep soundly* do *think* unless they *dream*; If not, then at that time they have no *Ideas*, and consequently no *Idea* is *Innate*, for what is *Innate* to us is never *Absent* from us.

ANSWER.

None of *Gods* Attributes can proceed from *outward objects* as from a *Pattern*, because there is nothing found in *God* like what is found in *External*, that is, *Corporeal* things; Now 'tis manifest that whatever we think of in him *differing* or *unlike* what we find in them proceeds not from them, but from a cause of that very *diversity* in our Thought.

And here I desire to know, how this Philosopher deduces *Gods Understanding* from *outward Things*, and yet I can easily explain what *Idea* I have thereof, by saying, that by the *Idea* of *Gods Understanding* I conceive whatever is the *Form* of any *Perception*; For who is there that does not perceive that he *understands* something or other, and consequently he must thereby have an *Idea* of *understanding*, and by enlarging it *Indefinitely* he forms the *Idea* of *Gods Understanding*. And so of his other Attributes.

And seeing we have made use of that *Idea* of *God* which is in us to demonstrate his existence, and seeing there is contain'd in this *Idea* such an *Immense Power*, that we conceive it a contradiction for *God* to *Exist*, and yet that any thing should *Be* besides Him, which was not *Created* by Him, it plainly follows that demonstrating His existence we demonstrate also that the whole world, or all things different from *God*, were *Created* by God.

Lastly when we assert, that some *Ideas* are *Innate* or *natural* to us, we do not mean that they are always present with us (for so no *Idea* would be *Innate*) but only that we have in our selves a Faculty of producing them.

OBJECT. XI.

* *The whole stress of which Argument lyes thus; because I know it impossible for me to be of the same nature I am, viz, having the Idea of a God in me, unless really there were a God, A God (I say) that very same God, whose Idea I have in my mind.*

Wherefore seeing 'tis not *demonstrated* that we have an *Idea* of *God*, and the Christian Religion commands us to believe that *God* is *Inconceivable*, that is, as I suppose, that we cannot have an *Idea* of Him, it follows, that the *Existence* of *God* is not demonstrated, much less *the Creation*.

ANSWER.

When *God* is said to be *Inconceivable* 'tis understood of an *Adequate full conception*. But I am 'een tired with often repeating, how notwithstanding we may have an *Idea* of *God*. So that here is nothing brought that makes any thing against my *demonstration*.

OBJECT. XII.

Against the Fourth Meditation, Of Truth and Falshood.

* By Which I understand that Error (as it is Error) is not a Real Being, Dependent on God, but is only a Defect; and that therefore to make me Err there is not requisite a Faculty of Erring Given me by God.

'Tis Certain that Ignorance is only a Defect, and that there is no Occasion of any Positive Faculty to make us Ignorant. But this position is not so clear in Relation to Error, for Stones and Inanimate Creatures cannot Err, for this Reason only, because they have not the Faculties of Reasoning or Imagination; from whence 'tis Natural for us to Conclude, That to Err there is requisite a Faculty of Judging, or at least of Imagining, both which Faculties are Positive, and given to all Creatures subject to Error, and to Them only.

Moreover Des-Cartes says thus, I find (my Errors) to Depend on two concurring Causes, viz. on my Faculty of Knowing, and on my Faculty of Choosing, or Freedom of my Will. Which seems Contradictious to what he said before; And here also we may note, that Freedom of Will is assumed without any Proof contrary to the Opinion of the Calvinists.

ANSWER.

Tho to make us Err there is requisite a Faculty of Reasoning (or rather of Judging, that is, of Affirming and Denying) because Error is the Defect thereof, yet it does not follow from thence that this Defect is any thing Real, for neither is Blindness a Real Thing, tho stones cannot be said to be Blind, for this Reason only, That they are incapable of sight. And I much wonder that in all these Objections I have not found one Right Inference.

I have not here assumed any thing concerning the Freedom of Mans Will, unless what all Men do Experience in themselves, and is most evident by the Light of Nature. Neither see I any Reason, Why he should say that this is Contradictious to any former Position.

Perhaps there may be Many, who respecting Gods predisposal of Things cannot Comprehend, How their Freedom of Will Consists there-with, but

yet there is no Man who, respecting himself only, does not find by Experience, That 'tis one and the same Thing to be *Willing*, and to be *Free*. But 'tis no Place to Enquire what the Opinion of others may be in this Matter.

OBJECT. XIII.

** As for Example, When lately I set my self to examine Whether any Thing Do Exist, and found, that from my setting my self to examine such a Thing, it evidently follows, That I my self Exist, I could not but Judge, what I so clearly understood, to be true, not that I was forced thereto by any outward Impulse, but because a strong Propension in my Will did follow this Great Light in my Understanding, so that I believed it so much the more Freely and Willingly, by how much the Less indifferent I was thereunto.*

This expression, *Great Light in the Understanding*, is *Metaphorical*, and therefore not to be used in Argumentation; And every one, that Doubts not of his Opinion, Pretends such a *Light*, and has no less a *Propension* in his Will to Affirm what he doubts not, than He that *really* and *truely* knows a Thing. Wherefore this *Light* may be the cause of *Defending* and *Holding* an Opinion *Obstinately*, but never of *knowing* an Opinion *Truly*.

Moreover not only the *Knowledge* of *Truth*, but *Belief* or *Giving Assent*, are not the *Acts* of the *Will*; for Whatever is *proved* by *strong Arguments*, or *Credibly* told, we Believe whether we will or no.

'Tis true, To *Affirm* or *Deny* Propositions, to *Defend* or *Oppose* Propositions, are the *Acts* of the *Will*; but it does not from thence Follow that the *Internal Assent* depends on the *Will*. Wherefore the following Conclusion (*so that in the abuse of our Freedom of Will that Privation consists which Constitutes Error*) is not fully Demonstrated.

ANSWER.

'Tis not much *matter*, Whether this expression, *Great Light*, be *Argumentative* or not, so it be explicative, as really it is, For all men know, that by *light in the understanding* is meant *clearness* of *knowledge*, which every one has not, that *thinks* he has; and this hinders not but this *light* in the *Understanding* may be very different from an *obstinate Opinion* taken up without *clear perception*.

But when 'tis here said, *That we assent to things clearly perceived whether we will or no*, 'tis the same, as if it were said, *that willing or*

nilling, we desire *Good clearly known*; whereas the word *Nilling*, finds no room in such Expressions, for it implies, that we will and nill the same thing.

OBJECT XIV.

Against the Fifth Meditation. Of the Essence of material things.

* As when for Example, I imagine a Triangle, tho perhaps such a Figure exists no where out of my thoughts, nor ever will exist, yet the Nature thereof is determinate, and its Essence or Form is immutable and eternal, which is neither made by me nor depends on my mind, as appears from this, that many propositions may be demonstrated of this Triangle.

If a Triangle be no where, I understand not how it can have any Nature, for what is no where, is not, and therefore has not a *Being*, or any Nature.

A Triangle in the *Mind* arises from a Triangle *seen*, or from one made up of what has been seen, but when once we have given the name of a *Triangle* to a thing (from which we think the *Idea* of a *Triangle* arises) tho the Triangle it self perish, yet the *name* continues; In the like manner, when we have once conceived in our thought, *That all the Angles of a Triangle are equal to two right ones*, and when we have given this other name (viz. *Having its three Angles equal to two right ones*) to a Triangle, tho afterwards there were no such thing in the World, yet the *Name* would still continue, and this Proposition, *A Triangle is a Figure having three Angles equal to two right Ones*, would be *eternally true*. But the Nature of a Triangle will not be eternal if all Triangles were destroy'd.

This Proposition likewise, *A Man is an Animal*, will be *true to Eternity*, because the Word *Animal* will eternally signifie what the Word *Man* signifies; but certainly if *Mankind* perish, *Humane Nature* will be no longer.

From whence 'tis Manifest, That *Essence* as 'tis distinguish'd from *Existence* is nothing more than the *Copulation* of Names by this word *Is*, and therefore *Essence* without *Existence* is meerly a *Fiction* of our own; and as the *Image* of a *Man* in the *Mind* is to a *Man*, so it seems *Essence* is to *Existence*. Or as this Proposition *Socrates is a Man*, is to this, *Socrates Is or Exists*, so is the *Essence* of *Socrates* to his *Existence*. Now this Proposition, *Socrates is a Man*, when *Socrates* does not exist, signifies only the Connection of the Names, and the word *Is* carries under it the *Image* of the *unity* of the thing, which is called by these *Two Names*.

ANSWER.

The Difference between *Essence* and *Existence* is known to all Men. And what is here said of *Eternal Names* instead of *Eternal Truth*, has been long ago sufficiently rejected.

OBJECT. XV.

Against the Sixth Meditation. Of the Existence of Material Beings.

* And seeing God has given me no Faculty to know whether these Ideas proceed from Bodies or not, but rather a strong inclination to believe, that these Ideas are sent from Bodies, I see no reason, why God should not be counted a Deceiver, if these Ideas came from any where, but from Corporeal Beings, and therefore we must conclude that Corporeal Beings exist.

'Tis a received opinion, that Physicians who deceive their Patients for their Healths sake, and Fathers, who deceive their Children for their Good, are guilty thereby of no Crimes, for the *fault* of Deceit does not consist in the *falsity* of Words; but in the *Injury* done to the Person deceived.

Let *D. Cartes* therefore consider whether this Proposition, *God can upon no account deceive us*, Universally taken be *true*; For if it be not *true* so universally taken, that Conclusion, *Therefore Corporeal Beings exist*, will not follow.

ANSWER.

'Tis not requisite for the establishment of my Conclusion, *That we cannot be deceived on any account* (for I willingly granted, that we may be *often* deceived) but that we cannot be deceived, when that our *Error* argues that in *God* there is such a *Will to Cheat* us as would be *contradictious* to his *Nature*. And here again we have a *wrong inference* in this *Objection*.

The Last Objection.

* For now I plainly discover a great difference between them (that is sleep and waking) for my Dreams are never conjoyn'd by my Memory, with the other Actions of my Life.

I desire to Know, whether it be certain, that a Man *dreaming*, that the doubts whether he *dream or not*, may not *Dream*, that he joyns his *Dream* to the *Ideas* of things past long since; if he may, than those *Actions* of his past life, may be thought as *true* if he were awake.

Moreover because (as *D. Cartes* affirms) the *Certainty* and *truth* of all *knowledge* depends only on the *knowledge* of the *True God*, either an Atheist cannot from the *Memory* of his past life conclude that he is *awake*, or else 'tis possible for a man to know that he is *awake* without the *Knowledge* of the *True God*.

ANSWER.

A Man that *dreams* cannot *really* connect his *dreams* with the *Ideas* of past things, tho, I confess, he may *dream* that he so connects them; for whoever deny'd That a man when he is *a sleep* may be *Deceived*? But when he awakens he may easily discover his Error.

An Atheist from the memory of his past life may collect that he is awake, but he cannot know, that this *Sign* is sufficient to make him *certain*, that he is not *deceived*, unless he know that he is *created* by a *God* that will not *deceive* him.

FINIS.

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